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No Half Truths

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CM LAYS FOUNDATION STONE FOR WASTE PROCESSING PLANTS P3



WILL HELP PEOPLE WHERE TRUTH IS BEING CRUSHED: RAHUL P5

'ALL GREAT THINGS IN LIFE ARE ALWAYS HARD' P12

British-era civil services exam had Sanskrit paper: PM Modi



MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 3

Highlighting a historical detail from India's pre-Independence administrative setup, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has pointed out that even under British rule, the civil services examination included a paper in Sanskrit.

Addressing the centenary celebrations of the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) at the Bharat Mandapam on Thursday, the prime minister shared an observation from an archival exhibition set up at the venue, CONTINUED ON P4

INDIA SET TO FINISH FOURTH

Late gold rush lifts spirits

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, October 3

The star-studded cricket and hockey teams predictably defended their crowns, but it was 17-year-old archer Kumkum Mohod and golfer Pranavi Urs, who scripted unexpected history, adding to the late gold rush that powered India to a creditable fourth place in the Asian Games on Saturday.

The country could not repeat or better the 106 medals claimed in the previous edition, but the haul of 85 is a decent enough performance although better was expected, especially from shooters and badminton players. In the end, India secured 21 gold, 27 silver and 37 bronze medals.

Eleven of these 21 gold medals came in the last two days and the final positions could still change slightly as a couple of equestrian competitions are scheduled on Sunday where India's nearest competitor Uzbekistan is in fray.

But Saturday was a day full of celebrations for the country as familiar stars of cricket and hockey delivered with elan.

The Shreyas Iyer-led cricket team secured a 19-run win over arch-foes Pakistan in Nisshin, the hockey players, led by the redoubtable Harmanpreet Singh, were also clinical in Kakamigahara against Malaysia, beating them 5-1 in the final.

For the hockey side, the gold also secured direct qualification to the 2028 Olympic Games in Los Angeles.

Another gold-winner on the day was the very under-stated Olympic bronze-medallist Aman Sehrawat. CONTINUED ON P4



Team holds the national flag as they celebrate after winning the final T20I cricket match against Pakistan, at the 20th Asian Games PTI

ASIAN GAMES

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- FOR THE HOCKEY SIDE, THE GOLD ALSO SECURED DIRECT QUALIFICATION TO THE 2028 OLYMPIC GAMES IN LOS ANGELES

CEC REMOVAL

Protest continues...



A protester stands on top of a barricade as other protesters try to breach it during a protest near Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi on Saturday ANI

Around 150 protesters detained

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 3

Protests continued in the heart of the Capital on the second day on Saturday focussing on the demand for resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar with the police detaining around 150 protesters, including AISA national president Neha Bora, activist Yogendra Yadav and senior advocate Prashant Bhushan.

The protesters were detained as they marched from Patel Chowk towards Jantar Mantar to protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar. AISA members said senior advocates Kapil Sibal, Nitya Ramakrishnan, Pallav Sisodia and Prashant Bhushan, along with activist Yogendra Yadav, joined Bora and other students during the march.

Police began detaining protesters as they gathered near the protest site, with security personnel deployed at multiple points and barricades placed on roads leading towards Jantar Mantar.

AISA members alleged that a male police officer manhandled Bora during the police action and that another Delhi Police officer abused her. The allegations could not be independently verified immediately.

The fresh mobilisation came after Bora, who was among those detained on Friday, called on activists to return to Jantar Mantar at 1 pm and continue their protest CONTINUED ON P4

DAY 2

- The protesters were detained as they marched from Patel Chowk towards Jantar Mantar to protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar
- AISA members said senior advocates Kapil Sibal, Nitya Ramakrishnan, Pallav Sisodia and Prashant Bhushan, along with activist Yogendra Yadav, joined Bora and other students during the march
- The development comes a day after nearly 1,000 protesters were detained from Jantar Mantar and surrounding areas as police and paramilitary personnel prevented large groups from reaching the protest site

Briefs

Brazil overpower India 4-0

KOLKATA: India fought gallantly for initial 25 minutes but five-time champions Brazil showed the vast gulf between the teams with a neatly executed 4-0 win in their FIFA international friendly here on Saturday. Carlo Ancelotti's new-look side, which is in a rebuilt mode post their pre-quarterfinal exit in the World Cup 2026, largely played within themselves without injecting much pace in their historic friendly. India, backed by a crowd that swelled to 51,402, had their moments in the first 25 minutes but were unable to find the goal. SEE P6

Co-pilot identified as Omani

NEW YORK: An Omani citizen, Hamam al-Hammami, has been identified as the flydubai co-pilot who attacked Indian Captain Smit Machchhar and allegedly attempted to take control of a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight this week, according to media reports. Al-Hammami was reportedly previously barred from flying in Oman over concerns about his radical ideological views, the Wall Street Journal reported on Saturday, quoting people familiar with the matter. On flydubai flight FZ1073 on Wednesday, he attacked Machchhar with a crash axe, typically kept in the cockpit for use in emergencies, seriously injuring him. SEE P6

SENIOR JOURNO ALSO JOINS

AAP's Kakkar, ex-UP minister join Congress

AAISHA SABIR
New Delhi, October 3

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief national spokesperson Priyanka Kakkar, former Uttar Pradesh minister and eight-time MLA Shyam Sunder Sharma, and senior journalist Rajat Rakesh Tandon joined the Congress on Saturday at the AICC headquarters.

They were inducted in the presence of AICC general secretary Naseer Hussain, CWC member Rajeev Shukla, Media and Publicity chairman Pawan Khera and Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee president Devender Yadav.

Explaining her exit, Kakkar said AAP had promised its leaders would not take bungalows or cars, but choppers were later used for private travel. "I could no longer defend the indefensible," she said, adding that the party had failed to retain people of substance. She called Rahul Gandhi the only "authentic" and "resilient" leader in Indian politics and alleged that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar was stealing votes in favour of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Tandon, who covered the Congress as a journalist for nearly two decades and belongs to the family of freedom fighter Purushottam Das Tandon, said he sought no post. Over the past ten years, he said, Rahul Gandhi was the one leader who "stood firm and could not be managed".

Sharma, who won the TMC's lone CONTINUED ON P4



> AAP HAD PROMISED ITS LEADERS WOULD NOT TAKE BUNGALOWS OR CARS, BUT CHOPPERS WERE LATER USED FOR PRIVATE TRAVEL

Assam NRC: Rejection slips process yet to begin, SC told

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 3

The Centre has told the Supreme Court that the process of issuing rejection slips to 1.9 million people, who were excluded from Assam's National Register of Citizens (NRC), has not begun yet because the final NRC is yet to be formally notified.

According to the Final National Register of Citizens released in August 2019, names of 19.07 lakh applicants were excluded from the list while 3.11 crore applicants were included in the final NRC.

In an affidavit filed before the top court, the Registrar General of India submitted that the state NRC coordinator was still working on a "security regime" for preserving NRC data.

The data has not yet been handed over to the Registrar General, who can notify the CONTINUED ON P4

KEY POINTS

- According to the Final National Register of Citizens released in August 2019, names of 19.07 lakh applicants were excluded from the list while 3.11 crore applicants were included in the final NRC
- In an affidavit filed before the top court, the Registrar General of India submitted that the state NRC coordinator was still working on a 'security regime' for preserving NRC data



Global debt, AI among 5 financial stability risks: RBI

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Saturday cautioned that the financial system's resilience today should not be seen as a guarantee against future vulnerabilities, and called for continued vigilance to safeguard financial stability.

"Our experience of the past two decades offers an important lesson: banking stress can build quickly and take years to resolve. It took nearly a decade to clean up the legacy of excessive lending and NPAs from the early 2000s. We cannot afford to become complacent; the economic and financial costs of allowing vulnerabilities to build up are simply too high," he said.

Speaking at the Kautilya Economic Conclave here, he outlined five priorities for policymakers, stressing that financial stability should focus not on preventing shocks but on strengthening the financial system's ability to withstand and contain their impact.

"Today's resilience may not necessarily imply tomorrow's immunity, and we are committed to remain vigilant of emerging vulnerabilities and continue to keep our financial system strong and resilient," he said, highlighting the resilience of the financial system supported by healthy balance sheets of banks and NBFCs.

He said shocks, whether endogenous or exogenous, are inevitable and the objective should be to build a financial system capable of providing financial services even under severe stress.

Malhotra also flagged a new generation of systemic risks that are CONTINUED ON P4



RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra PTI

COMPANY SAYS PRODUCT IS SAFE, MEETS ALL REGULATORY NORMS

Nestle dairy whitener gets FSSAI red flag

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 3

A sample of "low-fat dairy whitener" manufactured by Nestle India, drawn from the premises of Hotel Lalit in Connaught Place in the national capital, has been found "unsafe and substandard", the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) said.

However, responding to the development, Nestlé India said it complies with all applicable regulatory requirements and its low-fat dairy whitener is safe to consume.

In a post on social media, the food regulator said a sample was collected from the premises of Bharat Hotels Ltd (The Lalit), Connaught Place, New Delhi.

According to the FSSAI, the report of the food analyst's laboratory declared the product "substandard" and "unsafe", indicating non-compliance under the Food Safety and Standards (FSS) Act, 2006.

A copy of the laboratory analysis report was provided to the food business operator (FBO) for reference and necessary action, the regulator said. A notice has also been issued to Bharat Hotels Ltd over the non-compliant product.

The FBO was given an opportunity to appeal against the food analyst's report under the relevant section of the FSS Act, 2006, within the prescribed period.

The FBO has also been directed to immediately stop the sale of the identified unsafe food product, the FSSAI added.

Nestle India, in a statement, said its "Low Fat Dairy Whitener is safe to consume and complies with all applicable regulatory requirements. Phosphorus is a nutrient that occurs naturally in milk and is therefore present in all milk-based products."

It further said FSSAI lab reports reflect total phosphorus against the additive limit, without accounting for the substantial natural phosphorus contribution from milk-based ingredients.

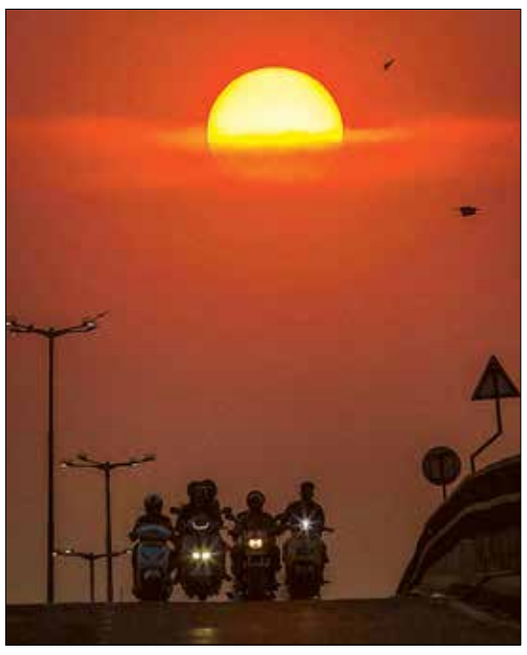
"Our product is in full compliance for added phosphorus as per prescribed limits under FSSR, including for as-consumed CONTINUED ON P4



'UNSAFE AND SUBSTANDARD'

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ON THE MOVE



Commuters proceed on a road as the sun sets in the background, in Bengaluru, on Saturday PTI

'INDIA HAS TAKEN STEPS TO BOOST DOMESTIC EXPLORATION'

Sanctions, tariffs become policy tools, sometimes weaponised: P K Mishra

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

Principal Secretary to the prime minister, P K Mishra, on Saturday said export restrictions, sanctions and tariffs become instruments of economic policy and they are sometimes even weaponised.

The top government functionary also said that wars disrupt energy and food markets while shipping routes and geographical choke points become sources of economic vulnerability.

Addressing the Kautilya Economic Conclave on the subject 'A World Priced for Risk', he said India is a major energy importer, and any prolonged disruption to an important maritime route can affect the economy adversely. India's response, therefore, has combined several layers of protection.

"For energy security, the disruption around the Strait of Hormuz has been a particularly clear reminder of how geography can translate into economic risk," he said.



Principal Secretary to the PM, P K Mishra

INDIA IS A MAJOR ENERGY IMPORTER, AND ANY PROLONGED DISRUPTION TO AN IMPORTANT MARITIME ROUTE CAN AFFECT ECONOMY ADVERSELY

Without mentioning any country, the top official said export restrictions, sanctions and tariffs become instruments of economic policy, sometimes they are even weaponised. The US has in the past announced tariffs on a number of countries, including India, for a variety of reasons.

Recently, the US has enacted the 'Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026', which authorises tariffs of up to 100 per cent on nations purchasing Russian oil and gas, including India and China.

Mishra said India has maintained substantial stocks, increased domestic production where possible, diversified procurement, and ensured that alternative supply routes and suppliers are available. For example, he said, the number of countries from which India imports crude oil has increased from 27 to 43, which is "very large".

"The same logic applies to energy transition. Greater domestic capacity in renewables, nuclear energy, storage and associated technologies is not only about sustainability, it is also about reducing exposure to external shocks over time," he said.

Mishra said that another example is critical minerals and strategic industrial inputs, this being an area where distinction between efficiency & resilience becomes important. "Critical minerals, technologies & even financial infrastructure acquire a new strategic significance," he said.

The top official of the Modi government said there is another question arising -- if the energy will be available or if it can reach its destination. "A disruption in a major shipping route can affect the price of crude oil thousands of kilometres away. Geography has therefore become an economic variable. The same is true for supply chain," he said.

Mishra said uncertainty arises when people cannot reliably assign probability, and the events of this decade have brought this distinction into sharp focus.

"We have seen a pandemic disrupt production and mobility across the world," he said. Mishra said India has taken steps to strengthen domestic exploration, processing and recycling through the National Critical Mineral Mission.

At the same time, he said, India has built a growing network of international partnerships on critical minerals, examples of those are with countries like the United States, France, Germany, Netherlands, and many others, for exploration, processing, recycling, technology and supply chain resilience.

The principal secretary to the prime minister said there is one more form of resilience that, of course, is perhaps less visible, and that is macroeconomic resilience.

KEY POINTS

- 'For energy security, the disruption around the Strait of Hormuz has been a particularly clear reminder of how geography can translate into economic risk'
- Mishra said India has maintained substantial stocks, increased domestic production where possible, diversified procurement, and ensured that alternative supply routes and suppliers are available
- 'Critical minerals, technologies and even financial infrastructure acquire a new strategic significance,' he said

Global uncertainty now a 'standing condition': Nirmala Sitharaman

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday said global uncertainty is now a "standing condition" and there is a need to design policies which build resilience, and called upon nations to have an open and predictable economic relationship.

Listing out four priorities for India for dealing with the next decade of global economic shock, Sitharaman said it is now time to have "autonomy" in building resilient supply chains, and for the private sector to lead investments, including in R&D.

Sitharaman also said that the industry must play a greater role in designing and delivering training, for skill development amidst a "changing world of work".

"Uncertainty is now a standing condition of the global economy, and policy must be designed around it. We need to keep building resilience as we go along; it is not a one-time exercise. The coming years call for preparation, and India approaches them from strength," the minister said at the Kautilya Economic Conclave 2026.

Talking about open, predictable and rule-based global economic relationships, Sitharaman said nations should engage with one another through dialogue and negotiated agreements, rather than allowing geopolitical differences to become barriers to trade and investment.

"International trade policy should provide greater certainty for businesses, respect national development priorities, and avoid unnecessary restrictions that fragment markets," she said. Stating that national security requires structural autonomy in strategic inputs, Sitharaman said focus should be on optimising supply chains to replace fragile single-source dependencies with domestic operational depth.

Sitharaman said India's expenditure on R&D stands at 0.83 per cent of GDP, compared with 2.7 per cent for the OECD, while the private sector contributes only 36 per cent of India's total R&D expenditure.

Calling for the private sector to lead the cycle of investments, Sitharaman said "raising both the scale of investment and private sector participation is essential to strengthening our innovation capacity".

The minister said for India, resilience means building upon the structural foundations laid over the past decade to accelerate and broaden growth.

"The test of the coming years will again be partly invisible: the shocks India absorbs without disruption to households and enterprises," she said.

Adani Airports to redevelop Mumbai airport's T1 North Section from January

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 3

Adani Airports will begin phased redevelopment of Mumbai airport's ageing Terminal 1 from January 2027, starting with the North Section of Terminal 1B, citing safety concerns around the nearly 60-year-old facility.

About 5 million passengers annually, or roughly 9 per cent of Mumbai airport's total traffic of around 55 million, will be temporarily affected in the first phase, while 91 per cent of traffic will continue normally, Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL) said on Saturday. Airlines operating from the affected section can temporarily shift services to the newly operational Navi Mumbai International Airport, with AAHL supporting the transition.

"91 per cent of Mumbai Airport's passenger traffic will remain unaffected... Only the North Section of Terminal 1B, which accounts for around one-third of T1's capacity, is being demolished in Phase 1 to minimise passenger inconvenience and operational disruption," said Arun Bansal, CEO, AAHL.

Terminal 1 handles about 15 million passengers annually & its redevelopment is expected to raise capacity by 33 per cent to 20 million. Bansal said passenger safety must remain paramount, adding that consultations with airlines have been underway since 2020 and the redevelopment was incorporated into the approved tariff framework. He said Navi Mumbai airport's availability makes phased redevelopment possible without shutting the entire terminal.

Navi Mumbai is offering a 100 per cent discount on landing fees for new international flights. AAHL said Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports will operate as complementary facilities.

Sai reaches Singapore for SING Forum 2026

During the forum, he will participate in a CEO Roundtable with leading investors and industry representatives from Singapore

MPOST BUREAU
Raipur, October 3



Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai reached Singapore on Saturday to expand new investment opportunities for Chhattisgarh. India's High Commissioner to Singapore Dr Shilpak Ambule welcomed the Chief Minister upon his arrival.

The Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India, has nominated Chhattisgarh to participate in the first SING Forum 2026.

Organised by the Singapore Business Federation, the prestigious international forum will provide Chhattisgarh an opportunity to showcase its achievements, development potential and attractive investment opportunities to global investors.

Sai will represent Chhattisgarh at SING Forum 2026. During the forum, he will participate in a CEO Roundtable with leading investors and industry representatives from Singapore.

Discussions will focus on investment prospects in Chhattisgarh and opportunities available across various sectors.

Sai said the state government is making concerted efforts to position Chhattisgarh among the country's leading investment destinations by leveraging its new industrial policy, abundant natural resources, strong infrastructure, skilled human resources and opportunities in emerging sectors.

He said creating a strong identity for Chhattisgarh on the global investment map is a top priority for the state government.

Chief Minister Sai's participation in SING Forum 2026 will provide an important opportunity to present Chhattisgarh's development potential and investment opportunities to global investors.

D-Mart Q2 revenue rise 18% to ₹19,206 cr, store count at 518

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 3

Avenue Supermarts, which owns and operates the retail chain D-Mart, reported an 18.4 per cent rise in standalone revenue from operations to Rs 19,206.18 crore for the second quarter ended September 30, 2026.

The company had reported revenue from operations at Rs 16,218.79 crore a year ago, Avenue Supermarts said in a regulatory filing on Saturday.

"Standalone Revenue from operations for the quarter ended September 30, 2026, stood at Rs 19,206.18 crore," the company said.

The total number of stores stood at 518 as of September 30.

On a quarter-on-quarter basis, D-Mart's revenue climbed 4.7 per cent. Its revenue was Rs 18,343.49 in the June quarter.

Promoted by Radhakishan Damani and his family, D-Mart retails basic home and personal products across markets, including Maharashtra, Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, NCR, Tamil Nadu, Punjab and Rajasthan.

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Place : Gurugram

To
THE BORROWER/S
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Flat No. H-53, 6th Floor, Tower H, Hill View Garden,
8 Mile Stone Alwar Bypass Road Bhiwadi, Rajasthan
Also at:
MUKESH CHAUHAN S/O SUKHPAL SINGH CHAUHAN
Om Shakti Industrial Sales Corporation,
Plot No. H 445, R11 Co Industrial Area, KushkheraBhiwadi, Rajasthan-301707
Also at:
MUKESH CHAUHAN S/O SUKHPAL SINGH CHAUHAN
M-107, South City, Part-1, Gurgaon
THE GUARANTOR/S
JYOTI VERMA
M 107 SOUTH CITY 1 GURGAON
Sir/ Madam,
Notice under Sec.13 (2) read with Sec.13 (3) of Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.
The addressee No 1 herein have availed the following credit facilities from our SECTOR-14 OLD DLF, GURGAON (4492)Branch and failed to pay the dues/instalment/ interest / operate the accounts satisfactorily and hence, in terms of the RBI guidelines as to the Income Recognition and Prudential Accounting Norms, your account/s has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset as on 29/05/2026. As on 30.06.2026, a sum of Rs. 384353.26 (Rupees three lakh, eighty-four thousand, three hundred and fifty-three point twenty-six) is outstanding in your account/s.
The particulars of amount due to the Bank from No.1 of you in respect of the aforesaid account/s are as under:

Type of Facility	Outstanding amount as on date of NPA i.e. as 29/05/2026	Un applied interest w.e.f. 29/05/2026 to	Penal Interest (Simple)	Cost/ Charges incurred by Bank	Total dues
CORP HOME EMI	372534.00	11819.26		0.00	384353.26
	Total Dues				384353.26

To secure the repayment of the monies due or the monies that may become due to the Bank, **MUKESH CHAUHAN,** had/ have executed documents on **16.02.2009** and created security interest by way of :
Mortgage of immovable property described herein below :
EMG of Flat No H-53, 6th Floor, Tower H, Hill View Garden, 8 Mile Stone Alwar Bypass Road, Bhiwadi, Rajasthan.
Therefore You are hereby called upon in terms of section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, to pay a sum of Rs. 384353.26 together with further interest and charges at the contractual rate as per the terms and conditions of loan documents executed by you and discharge your liabilities in full within 60 days from the date of receipt of this notice , failing which, we shall be constrained to enforce the aforesaid securities by exercising any or all of the rights given under the said Act.
As per section 13 (13) of the Act, on receipt of this notice you are restrained /prevented from disposing of or dealing with the above securities without the consent of the bank.
Your attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the SARFAESI in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Yours Faithfully
Authorised Officer

GAIL marketing director Sanjay Kumar named as Managing Director & CEO of Petronet LNG Ltd

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 3

State-owned GAIL (India) Ltd's Director (Marketing) Sanjay Kumar has been appointed Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of Petronet LNG Ltd, effective May 13, 2027, when the position falls vacant.

According to a regulatory filing, Petronet's board cleared the top-level appointment during a brief 15-minute meeting held on October 2.

Kumar will take over on May 13, 2027, when the existing CEO A K Singh's extended tenure ends. Kumar, 59, will have a five-year term.

Petronet, India's largest gas importer, is majority owned by state-owned oil firms.

While the superannuation age in public sector companies is 60 years, Petronet, though headed by the government's top bureaucrat in the Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, is registered as a private limited company.



Sanjay Kumar, Director (Marketing), Gail

Petronet is not under any government watchdog like CAG or CVC and is beyond the purview of RTI. Its board executives enjoy higher remuneration than PSUs and also retire at the age of 65 years.

State-owned Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), GAIL (India) Ltd, Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) hold a 12.5 per cent stake each in the company.

The heads of the four blue-chip oil firms, who sit on the board of Petronet, superannuate at the age of 60 years.

Kumar has been director for marketing at gas utility GAIL since mid-June 2023.

'Sebi to soon issue framework on Closing Auction Session'

The regulator would not require much time to compile and analyse the responses, the Sebi chairman added

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 3

Market regulator Sebi will soon issue a framework on proposed changes to the Closing Auction Session (CAS) mechanism after receiving more than 3,500 comments on its consultation paper, its Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday.

The Sebi had sought public comments on its proposal to review certain aspects of the CAS, market timings and the settlement methodology for derivative contracts. The deadline for submitting comments is October 3.

CLOSER LOOK

- The Sebi chairman said the consultation process was designed to address a specific problem while allowing market participants to suggest different approaches to resolving it
- The review followed the rollout of the CAS in the equity cash segment and concerns over its impact on derivatives settlement prices

Asked when the final framework or circular on CAS can be expected, Pandey said the regulator would quickly examine the responses and move ahead with the process.

"Today is the last date, and we will actually quickly look at all these comments and go ahead, because I think our proposals are quite clear," Pandey said at an event organised by CPAI (Commodity & Capital Market Participants Association of India).

The regulator would not require much time to compile and analyse the responses as the proposals in the consultation paper were clearly defined, he added. When asked whether a circular on the matter could be expected soon, he said, "Yes, it will be".

Sebi in September proposed changes to the CAS framework and the methodology for determining settlement prices of index and stock derivatives on expiry days. The review followed the rollout of the CAS in the equity cash segment and concerns over its impact on derivatives settlement prices.

The CAS is aimed at determining closing prices through an auction process.

Sebi has said the review is intended to address specific issues while seeking views on different possible ways of resolving them.

Pandey said the consultation process was designed to address a specific problem while allowing market participants to suggest different approaches to resolving it.

Separately, speaking about the development of the corporate bond derivatives market, Pandey said regulatory enablement, technical infrastructure and market participation would all be important for the segment to grow.

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SAYS 217 LAKH TONNES OF LANDFILL WASTE CLEARED

CM lays foundation stone for waste processing plants

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday said 217.17 lakh metric tonnes of waste had been disposed of from the Okhla, Bhalswa and Ghazipur landfill sites in the last 18 months, reclaiming nearly 100 acres of land, as she laid the foundation stone for new waste processing facilities.

Gupta said her government was working on two fronts – clearing legacy waste from existing landfill sites and ensuring that fresh waste generated every day was scientifically processed so that new garbage mountains do not take shape.

She was speaking during a visit to the Okhla landfill site, where she reviewed the progress of waste disposal and the capacity of new processing facilities. Foundation stones were also laid for facilities at Ghazipur and Singhola, besides a biogas plant at Ghazipur.

"The goal is not just to clear legacy waste but also scientifically process fresh waste to prevent new garbage mountains from taking shape," Gupta said.

The chief minister said the government had processed almost all the legacy waste at Okhla that existed before January 2025.

"Today, at Okhla, we have processed almost all the legacy waste that was there before January 2025," she said.

Gupta said around 3,000-4,000 metric tonnes of waste reached the Okhla site daily and the new fresh waste processing unit would ensure that it was processed regularly.

"Our government is fighting on both fronts, to finish the old mountains and to ensure that no new garbage mountain is created in the future," she said.

She said the government was working towards reducing the existing garbage mountains to zero.

"People are seeing that the garbage mountains are continuously shrinking and soon a time will come when they will become zero," Gupta said.

"Over the past around 18 months, 217.17 lakh metric tonnes of waste was disposed of at the Okhla, Bhalswa and Ghazipur landfill sites, freeing nearly 100 acres of land," CM Gupta said. The new facilities are aimed at processing fresh waste as well as construction and demolition waste. The government plans to use processed waste and cattle dung to produce biogas, green energy and manure. "Waste should not remain waste. Delhi should use it as wealth," Gupta said.

The chief minister directed officials to make the new processing units operational at the earliest and at their full capacity, saying merely removing waste from the surface would not be enough and the waste accumulated underneath also needed scientific processing.

The chief minister said the government was simultaneously working on increasing processing capacity, scientific waste management, waste-to-resource initiatives and renewable energy.

On pollution, she said the government was working on several fronts, including landfill waste, Yamuna cleaning, dust mitigation, plantation, road infrastructure and waste management.

"Environmental impact comes from everything. The garbage mountains, cleaning of the Yamuna and dust mitigation all have an impact," she said.

Delhi CEO to hold special SIR camps

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

The Delhi election office will organise special camps at all polling station locations and universities and colleges across the city as part of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, according to an official letter.

The camps at all polling station locations will be held on October 4 and 11 from 10 am to 5 pm, while those at colleges and universities will be organised on October 7 and 8 from 9 am to 3 pm, it said.

The decision has been taken to maximise enrolment of eligible electors in the electoral rolls in the capital, the letter issued by the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer on Thursday, said.

The Additional Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi, has directed all 13 District Election Officers to ensure the organisation of the camps across the city.

The letter further directed Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) and Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs) of all 70 assembly constituencies to ensure their full participation in the camps being organised at polling station locations and educational institutions.

The camps come as the SIR exercise in Delhi enters its final phase. The revised schedule published by the Delhi CEO's office provides for disposal of claims and objections up to October 3 and publication of the final electoral roll on October 7, it said.

AQI stays moderate at 171

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

The National Capital saw a slight increase in the maximum temperature on Saturday, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecasting sunny days for the next few days.

Safdarjung, a representative of the city's weather, recorded a maximum temperature of 37.1 degrees Celsius, 1.1 degrees more than Friday and a minimum temperature of 23.2 degrees Celsius, 0.9 degrees above normal and the same as the day before.

Palam recorded a maximum temperature of 34.8 degrees Celsius, 0.7 degrees more than the day before and a minimum temperature of 22.6 degrees Celsius, 0.1 degree more than the day before; Lodhi Road recorded a minimum of 22.4 degrees Celsius; Ayanagar recorded a minimum of 22.8 degrees Celsius.

"Mostly clear skies are expected to persist for the next few days," said an IMD official.

According to the IMD forecast, the maximum is likely to be around 36 degrees Celsius on Sunday. The minimum temperature is likely to be around 23 degrees Celsius.

Meanwhile, the air quality index (AQI) of the city remained in the moderate category on Saturday and the 24-hour average AQI was recorded at 171 (moderate) at 4 pm, as compared to the 24-hour average AQI of 174 (moderate) recorded at the same time on Friday, according to data from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB). As per CPCB standards, an AQI of 0-50 is considered 'good', 51-100 'satisfactory', 101-200 'moderate', 201-300 'poor', 301-400 'very poor', and 401-500 'severe'.

Gurugram man jumps to death from 43rd floor of Noida high-rise

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Noida, October 3

A man from Gurugram allegedly died by suicide on Saturday after jumping from the balcony of a flat on the 43rd-floor of a high-rise in Noida, police said.

The deceased, identified as Sambhav Jain, had booked an Airbnb setup at the Supernova Spyra society in Sector 94 for a day, police said.

According to police, Jain allegedly jumped from the balcony of the room, resulting in his death. A forensic team has collected evidence from the spot, they said.

Preliminary inquiry suggests that Jain was under mental stress, officials said.

Police are examining CCTV footage from cameras installed in the building and nearby areas.

Peeragarhi interchange to link Delhi Metro's Green, Magenta lines

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 3

People travelling between west Delhi neighbourhoods such as Peeragarhi, Peeragarhi Village, Udyog Nagar and Paschim Vihar will get a new Metro interchange at Peeragarhi, linking the Green and Magenta lines and providing a direct connection between the two corridors, a DMRC official said.

The interchange is being developed between the existing Peeragarhi station on the Green Line and the upcoming station on the Magenta Line's Krishna Park Extension-Deepali Chowk section under Phase 4, the official told PTI.

He said the new section is expected to open for passengers by the end of this year. For commuters, the facility will mean easier transfers between the Green Line, which connects areas along the Inderlok-Kirti Nagar and Brig Hoshiar Singh corridor and the Magenta Line, which links the western parts of the city with the southern and eastern parts through its Botanical Garden-Majlis Park corridor, according to DMRC.

Both the existing and upcoming stations at Peeragarhi are elevated. A 160-metre-long foot overbridge will connect the two sections within the paid area, allowing passengers to change lines without exiting the Metro system, he said.

About 90 per cent of the civil structure work at the station has been completed, while architectural finishing work is currently underway, the officials mentioned.

The interchange is expected to strengthen connectivity for residents and commuters in several densely populated parts of west Delhi.

The upcoming Krishna Park Extension-Deepali Chowk section is part of the Magenta Line expansion being taken up under Phase 4, which is adding new corridors and extending the reach of the Delhi Metro network to more parts of the capital, he said.

The Magenta Line currently has operational stretches between Botanical Garden and Krishna Park Extension and between Deepali Chowk and Majlis Park. The Phase 4 works will bridge these sections, adding connectivity through the western and northwestern parts of Delhi.

The Delhi Metro network currently has 31 interchange stations connecting different corridors. With the completion of Phase 4, around 18 more interchange stations are expected to be added, further expanding the network of line-to-line connections, he added.

Delhi govt plans 2 new multi-lane PUC centres

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

With the onset of the Delhi government's PUC verification drive ahead of the winter season, the transport department plans to establish two major multi-lane pollution under control certification centres at its biggest interstate bus terminals, Anand Vihar and Sarai Kale Khan, officials said on Saturday.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced last week a major pollution under control (PUC) certification enforcement drive as a step to control air pollution in the city.

"These will be dedicated multi-lane PUC centres for heavy and light motor vehicles, for testing and issuing certificates; a tender has been issued for the projects," an official said.

"While working on solutions to pollution, we identified a major gap. Commercial vehicles were getting fitness certificates from centres using old technology, while private vehicles were getting pollution certificates from booths outside petrol pumps," he added. Currently, Delhi has around 900 PUC centres that are located at petrol stations, and a few others in selected areas, the official said, adding that the two upcoming certification centres would be the first to be located at ISBTs.

'WE CARE'



Delhi Police personnel during a community awareness programme at Coronation Park under the 'WE CARE' initiative MPOST

Briefs

Delhi L-G meets AIIMS students

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Saturday assured medical students and resident doctors at AIIMS of full cooperation in addressing their concerns over safety and security, particularly those faced by women. Sandhu made the assurance during a "candid" interaction over coffee with medical students and resident doctors at a popular cafe at the AIIMS, Delhi, according to a post shared by the L-G on X.

Four held in Ggm house theft case

GURUGRAM: Police have arrested four men in connection with the theft of cash and jewellery from a house in Gurugram's Sector 52 and recovered Rs 17.30 lakh in cash, gold-melting equipment and tools allegedly used in the crime, officials said. According to police, a woman lodged a complaint on August 24 alleging that unidentified persons had stolen cash, jewellery and other articles from her house in R D City, Sector 52. A case was subsequently registered at Sector 53 police station.During the investigation, a Crime Branch team from Sector 43 arrested the four accused near Leisure Valley Ground in Sector 29 on September 20, police said.

CASE CAME TO LIGHT OCT 1 WHEN POLICE SPOTTED SUSPECT FLEEING

Four held as Delhi Police bust counterfeit currency racket, seize Rs 18L in fake notes

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

The Delhi Police has busted a counterfeit currency preparation unit allegedly being run from a rented room in Patel Nagar by a group that learnt the techniques through online videos and combined printing, die-cutting and graphic-designing skills to make fake notes, officials said on Saturday.

Four men have been arrested in connection with the racket and counterfeit currency with a face value of Rs 18.23 lakh, including finished and semi-finished notes, has been recovered, police said.

The accused allegedly operated the unit from a rented room in Baljeet Nagar, where police recovered printing and processing equipment, a laptop and a hard disk containing software and data related to the preparation of counterfeit notes, they said.

The case came to light on October 1 when police personnel patrolling in Janakpuri noticed a suspicious man attempting to flee on seeing them.

The man was apprehended and identified as Ankit Kumar (25). A search led to the recovery of 250 counterfeit notes of Rs 500 denomination, having a face value of Rs 1.25 lakh, from his possession. An FSL expert examined the notes at the spot and confirmed that they were counterfeit, police said. A case was registered at Janakpuri police station on October 2.

During interrogation, Ankit allegedly told police that he had obtained the counterfeit notes from Gagandeep Singh alias Manni and Kulwant Singh alias Kake, both residents of Patel Nagar, and was on his way to deliver or sell them.

Acting on the information, police apprehended Gagandeep (31) and Kulwant (44) from Baljeet Nagar on October 2.

A search of their rented room led to the recovery of finished and semi-finished counterfeit currency with a face value of Rs 16,98,800, along with equipment and material allegedly used to prepare the fake notes, police said.

During the investigation, the landlord, Amit (34), was also apprehended. Police said he was aware of the activities being carried out in the rented room and later allegedly joined the others in preparing counterfeit currency. He was subsequently arrested in the case.

According to police, Gagandeep had earlier worked at his maternal uncle's printing press and had experience in handling printing and die-cutting machinery, while Kulwant had knowledge of graphic designing and Photoshop. The two allegedly combined their skills to set up the counterfeit currency operation.

They allegedly watched online videos and tutorials to learn techniques for printing and processing fake currency. Amit allegedly provided the premises and subsequently became involved in the operation, while Ankit allegedly procured counterfeit notes for further supply.

Police said Ankit, a Class 12 pass-out who worked as a parking attendant, had allegedly purchased counterfeit Rs 500 notes with a face value of around Rs 2.50 lakh from Gagandeep for Rs 50,000.

Gagandeep allegedly joined the operation after suffering financial losses in online gaming, while Kulwant, who had earlier run a mobile phone shop and worked as a SIM card dealer, had previously been arrested in 2012 in a case relating to issuance of SIM cards using forged documents, police said.

Amit, who studied up to Class 10, had allegedly rented the room to Gagandeep and Kulwant in July this year for Rs 3,000 per month before becoming involved in the operation.

Besides the counterfeit currency, police recovered a laptop and hard disk containing software and data related to fake note printing, along with screen-printing frames, watermark dies, cotton fibre sheets, security-thread material, heat-laminating machines, colour printers, printing inks, a stepper, a cutter and other equipment.

Loan racket with Rs 5.3 cr transactions busted, two arrested

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

Delhi Police has busted a racket which allegedly used forged documents to obtain an unauthorised business loan of Rs 7.30 lakh in the name of a woman entrepreneur, officials said on Saturday.

A key accused, Sahil, 36, a resident of Haryana's Sonipat, has been apprehended in connection with the case, while another woman, aged 34, was located during a raid in Dwarka and bound over in the case, they said, adding that cumulative debit and credit transactions exceeding Rs 5.3 crore were detected in the linked bank accounts.

Police registered a case after a woman from Burari – running Medinex Hurbo Care since May 2022 – complained that her identity and company documents had been misused to obtain a business loan, Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) Niharika Bhatt said.

The complainant said, in July 2025, she received a call informing her that a loan of Rs 7.30 lakh had been obtained in her company's name in December 2023 and credited to a bank account. Since she had neither applied for nor availed of the loan, she initially suspected the call to be fraudulent and did not take further action.

However, in January this year, while applying for an education loan for her daughter, she discovered that her CIBIL score had been adversely affected by an unauthorised business loan sanctioned by a finance company in her company's name.

She alleged that her PAN, GST details, signature and other documents had been fraudulently used to secure the loan and that the amount was credited to a bank account opened in her name without her knowledge or consent.

Police said technical and financial analysis during the investigation traced the suspects to Sonipat and Dwarka. During the investigation, it was found that the loan amount sanctioned by the finance company was credited to a bank account in the woman's name, from which Rs 1 lakh was transferred in two transactions of Rs 50,000 each to accounts held by Sahil.

India can't give deadline on Hasina's extradition to B'desh: Envoy

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dhaka, October 3

India cannot give any deadline for ousted Bangladesh prime minister Sheikh Hasina's return as her extradition request is under examination through a legal process, Indian High Commissioner in Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi said on Saturday. "Nobody can give you a timeframe (over Hasina's return)," Trivedi said at a discussion organised by a private think tank in Dhaka, while responding to questions related to the repeated requests from Dhaka for Hasina's extradition to Bangladesh.

Hasina, 79, has been living in India after she fled Dhaka following the collapse of her government in August 2024 in the face of a massive anti-government agitation. India's external affairs ministry has maintained that the Bangladesh government's request for extraditing Hasina is being examined in line with established processes.

INDIA SLAMS PAKISTAN

Pak's 'so-called' civilian govts serve at mercy of their Army: India at UN

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
United Nations, October 3

India has slammed Pakistan at the UN, strongly rejecting its remarks about Jammu and Kashmir, telling the world organisation that the "so-called" civilian governments in Islamabad "serve at the mercy" of their Army and rarely complete their terms.

India exercised its Right of Reply in response to remarks by Pakistan at the UN General Assembly Third Committee meeting Friday, where the Pakistani delegate raised the issue of Jammu and Kashmir.

India "categorically" rejected those remarks, saying the Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh were, are and will always remain "integral and inalienable" parts of India.

"We all know that the so-called civilian governments in Pakistan serve at the mercy of their Army and rarely complete their terms," First Secretary at the Permanent Mission of India to the UN Bhavika Mangalanandan said as she delivered India's Right of Reply.



First Secretary at the Permanent Mission of India at UN Bhavika Mangalanandan

Referring to Pakistani leader Imran Khan, she said a "former Prime Minister continues to remain in jail, even as his health is reported to be fast deteriorating."

The erstwhile ruling party has not been allowed to contest elections.

"Instead of addressing domestic discontent, Pakistan seeks to distract by fomenting instability in India and sponsoring, inciting, abetting, and financing cross-border terrorism in my country for more than three decades," she said.

"The only outstanding matter is a vacation of the territory Pakistan holds under illegal and forcible occupation. We heard Pakistani laments regarding the people of Jammu and Kashmir."

"This is a desperate attempt by Pakistan to mask the ongoing tragedy in Rawalakot and its other cities, the killing of hundreds of civilians, and the brutal crackdown across Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir, for merely demanding bread, electricity and human dignity, said.

India called this "unsurprising", describing it as a natural outcome of prolonged Pakistani military occupation of the region by force and its unending repression.

"When any free media is banned from covering such news in Pakistan, the evidence becomes undeniable for the global community that only the writ of the Form 47 government and their masters and the Army headquarters runs large," she said, referring to a term used to describe allegations of rigging and manipulation in Pakistan's 2024 general elections.

India told the UNGA Third Committee, which deals with social, humanitarian and cultural Issues, that Jammu and Kashmir, by contrast to the situation in Pakistan, held Assembly Elections in 2024, with a massive turnout followed by a peaceful transfer of power to an elected government.

HIGHLIGHTS

- India exercised its Right of Reply in response to remarks by Pakistan at the UN General Assembly Third Committee meeting Friday
- India 'categorically' rejected those remarks, saying the Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh were, are and will always remain 'integral and inalienable' parts of India

Delays in Tejas combat jet programme hurting IAF: Air Chief Marshal

'The force requires induction of at least 36-40 fighter jets annually'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3

The inordinate delays in the induction of Tejas combat aircraft are hurting the Indian Air Force in view of the depleting strength of its fighter jet squadrons at a time when air power is becoming increasingly crucial to deal with security challenges, Chief of Air Staff Air Chief Marshal A P Singh said on Saturday.

Addressing a press conference ahead of Air Force Day, the IAF chief also said that the force requires induction of at least 36-40 fighter jets annually for the next few years and hoped that the situation will improve with induction of indigenously-built Tejas Mark-1A aircraft as well as Rafale combat jets to be procured under the multi-role fighter aircraft (MRFA) programme. Air Chief Marshal Singh said India is looking at finalising the MRFA deal by this financial year provided things go as per plan.



Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh addresses the annual press conference, in New Delhi, PTI

In its largest-ever defence acquisition push, India in February cleared a long-pending proposal to procure 114 Rafale fighter jets under a government-to-government framework with France, nearly two decades after the plan was originally rolled out to boost the Indian Air Force's combat prowess.

The price negotiations and other critical issues relating to the project are currently being finalised.

From page 1

British-era civil...

noting that legendary freedom fighter Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had appeared in a Sanskrit paper during his examination in 1920.

"While looking through the gallery, I noticed that it also contains information about how Subhas Chandra Bose went through this very process in 1920," the prime minister said, adding, "What caught my attention was that although India was under British rule at the time, there used to be a Sanskrit paper in the examination, and Subhas Babu wrote this paper," Modi said.

The prime minister also praised Bose and other historical stalwarts for their contributions, noting that many people transformed the examination process into a "legacy of trust" over the past century and elevated the institution to new heights.

Modi urged young aspirants and attendees to visit the gallery to appreciate the deep-rooted historical journey of India's civil services structure.

To mark the 100-year milestone of the UPSC, the prime minister also released a special commemorative coin, a postage stamp, and a book documenting the landmark decisions shaping public service commissions in India.

Late gold rush...

He picked up top honours in the 57kg category, reaffirming his calibre.

But Pranavi and Kumkum were the standout stories of the day.

While Kumkum became the first Indian woman archer to win an individual recurve gold, Pranavi achieved the same in golf, both displaying tremendous poise under pressure.

Kumkum, in fact, wouldv be heading back home with two gold and a silver medal to her credit in what can only be called a dream debut at the Games. The teenager from Maharashtra also secured an individual quota place for India in Olympic Games.

Pranavi also managed more than one medal as the Indian women's golf team finished with a silver thanks largely to her performance.

The other silver medal on the day came from wrestler Antim Panghal (women's 53kg), while recurve archer Neeraj Chauhan defeated his higher-rated compatriot Dhiraj Bommadevara to bag the men's individual bronze.

After sweeping the compound team event golds and securing a first ever women's team recurve gold, Kumkum's top finish made it a campaign to remember for the archery contingent.

Kumkum defeated South Korea's Oh Yejin 6-5 in the final after going past high-quality opponents in the previous two rounds.

She edged reigning world champion Kang Chaeyoung in the quarterfinal before putting it past world championships silver-medallist and former world No. 1 China's Jingyi Zhu in the semifinal in a campaign to remember.

The men's run, however, ended on a slightly disappointing note with Dhiraj and Neeraj squaring off for a bronze after failing to move beyond the semifinals.

The archers signed off with nine medals, including five gold medals.

Unable to sleep the previous night due to nerves, Pranavi was calmness personified as she held on to a slender one-stroke lead in the final round to achieve a historic women's individual gold in golf that also helped the country claim the team silver.

The 23-year-old from Mysore sent in three birdies to recover from a horrendous triple bogey on the third hole, which had wiped away her three-stroke overnight lead.

With a final round score of even-par 70, she ended with a total of 15-under 265 for four days, a stroke ahead of the pack.

"I like being the first to do things. People will come along to do more but the first will always be the first," a jubilant Pranavi said after the historic triumph.

Pranavi's performance also became a crucial factor in fetching India the team silver with other members being Aditi Ashok (67 in final round) and Diksha Dagar (77 in final round).

Aditi, who had won an individual silver in the last edition of the Games, produced her best performance of the week, slamming in six consecutive birdies against a double bogey and a bogey, to sign off tied 14th individually with a two-over 282 total. Diksha ended tied 23rd on the individual leaderboard with a 12-over total.

The two best scores are taken into account for deciding the team medals and India ended 14-under 546, well behind gold-winners China (22-under 538).

Abhishek Sharma was the familiar nemesis upfront while Tilak Varma became a tormentor towards the end as India lived up to its top billing by defending the Asian Games men's cricket gold with a 19-run win over Pakistan.

The pitch was a tricky one but eased out later as world's No. 1 T20I batter Abhishek smashed 61 off 28 balls, studded with seven sixes, and vice-captain Tilak silenced his critics with a top-notch unbeaten 51 off 22 balls.

India posted a mammoth 211 for 6 and even though an unheralded Hasan Nawaz (96 off 51 balls) gave everything he had to make a match of it, the result offered no surprises.

Pakistan were stopped at 192 for 6 in the end and India extended their dominance over the arch-rivals to take the head-to-head since the start of the 2024 T20 World Cup to 6-0.

In between, Nawaz punished the Indian spinners before Jasprit Bumrah's experience (0/33 in 4 overs) and Washington Sundar's (2/29 in 4 overs) calmness ensured that there were no surprises in the end.

On the hockey field too, it was India all the way as captain Harmanpreet Singh rose to the occasion with a brace to star in a 5-1 win over Malaysia that didn't secure gold for the second time but also ensured a ticket to the 2028 Olympics.

The men's team's gold came a day after the women defeated higher-ranked defending champions China 1-0 in the final to clinch the title after 44 years and also book an Olympic spot. This is the first time that both the men and women have ended on top in the same edition of the continental showpiece.

Captain Harmanpreet (11th and 57th), Jugraj Singh (23rd), Hardik Singh (42nd) and Shilanand Lakra (54th) scored for India. For Malaysia, Shello Silverius pulled one back in the 14th minute. With his twin strikes, Harmanpreet also ended as the tournament's top-scorer with 12 goals to his credit.

Aman upgraded his Asian Games bronze to gold while Antim Panghal's bid to become only the second Indian woman wrestler to win the continental title ended in disappointment after being outclassed by Japan's Moe Miyooka inthe final.

India signed off with six medals -- two gold, two silver and two bronze --in one of the best shows in the event, especially after missing out on top-of-the-podium place in Hangzhou Games in 2023.

Amanvheld his nerve to beat North Korea's reigning World Champion Chong Song Han 10-7 in the men's 57kg final.

This was India's second wrestling gold after Sujeet Kalkal's sensational title win on Friday.

India previously won two wrestling gold medals at Asian Games after the 2018 Jakarta game when Bajrang Punia and Vinesh Phogat had triumphed in their respective men's and women's events.

AAP's Kakkar...

Uttar Pradesh seat in 2012, assured the party of results in the state and said he would bring Mathura's district panchayat members into the Congress. On recent leadership changes in Uttar Pradesh and Punjab, Shukla said the decisions were strategic and in the party's interest, noting that former CLP leader Aradhana Mishra had been appointed state Congress chief.

Protest continues...

demanding Kumar's resignation and raising concerns over the SIR of electoral rolls.

The development comes a day after nearly 1,000 protesters were detained from Jantar Mantar and surrounding areas as police and paramilitary personnel prevented large groups from reaching the protest site. Many of those detained were subsequently released.

Meanwhile, Delhi Police has registered at least three FIRs in connection with Friday's protests, two at Parliament Street police station and one at Connaught Place police station, under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) for alleged disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant.

No individual or organisation has been named as an accused in the FIRs, though details of the organisers and organisations that proposed or participated in the demonstrations have been mentioned in their contents, a senior police officer said.

The FIRs relate to alleged violations of prohibitory orders imposed across the New Delhi district under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which prohibited gatherings of five or more people, processions, demonstrations, picketing, dharnas and slogan shouting without prior written permission.

On Friday evening, Bora said in a video message that the protest would continue and urged activists to return to Jantar Mantar. She said the detentions would not intimidate protesters and called for continued mobilisation in support of the demand for Kumar's resignation.

The protesters are opposing the SIR exercise and alleging irregularities in the revision of electoral rolls.

Delhi Police had denied permission for Friday's gathering and imposed heightened security measures in central Delhi. Several roads were barricaded and entry and exit at a number of Metro stations in the vicinity of Jantar Mantar were temporarily restricted during Friday's protest.

The demonstration comes days after The Indian Express reported that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions and orders on the SIR that they said were issued without their knowledge or recommendation.

In Mumbai, city police also registered an FIR against the organisers and 400-500 unidentified persons in connection with Cockroach Janta Party's October 2 Shivaji Park protest.

The case has been registered under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Maharashtra Police Act for unlawful assembly, wilful disobedience of lawful order issued by public servant, and other offences, a Shivaji Park police station official said.

The case was lodged on the complaint of a resident of the Shivaji Park area, he added. "No one has been arrested in the case. Further probe is underway," the official said.

The CJP, under its founder Abhijeet Dipke, had organised a massive protest at Shivaji Park on Friday seeking the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar for alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Assam NRC...

final NRC only after receiving it, the affidavit said.

"Enactment of the security regime for NRC data by the state coordinator is in progress, and hence data has not been shared with the Registrar General of India (RGI)," the affidavit said, adding that the process of issuing rejection slips "has not been started yet" by the state NRC coordinator.

The top court had earlier directed the state NRC coordinator to develop a mechanism for issuing rejection slips to people excluded from the final list so that they could approach foreigners tribunals for challenging their rejection.

The state NRC coordinator subsequently informed the RGI in October 2020 that rejection slips could be issued only after the latter notified the final NRC.

The apex court deferred the matter for hearing on November 6 after the Assam government sought time to file its response.

The top court was hearing petitions filed by the Assam State Jamiat Ulama, All Assam Minority Students Union, Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind and others seeking rejection slips for those excluded from NRC and NRC cards for those included in the final list. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Global debt...

increasingly exogenous, cross-border and interconnected.

The next financial crisis, he said, may not necessarily originate in a bank or even within the financial sector, but could begin with a geopolitical event, cyber attack or technological failure and affect the financial system through multiple channels.

He stressed the need to better understand network dependencies and contagion channels while making scenario analysis a cornerstone of risk management.

The RBI governor also called for improvements in monitoring and assessment frameworks through better and more granular data.

Data on non-banking financial institutions (NBFIs), interconnected exposures, technological developments and cross-border positions can remain fragmented, he said, adding that the data quality would increasingly determine the quality of risk assessment in an interconnected financial system.

He said resilience also needs to be "system-wide", noting that a strong banking system, while necessary, is not sufficient.

Resilience is required across NBFIs, financial markets, payment systems, technology infrastructure providers, critical third parties and cross-border financial networks, he said.

On financial innovation, Malhotra said technologies such as artificial intelligence and tokenisation, as well as new forms of financial intermediation, could significantly improve efficiency, but innovation must not undermine the foundations of trust in the financial system.

He emphasised sound institutions, settlement finality, singleness of money and financial integrity as fundamental properties that need to be preserved.

"The challenge before us is to build a financial system that can withstand shocks that we can anticipate, and even those we cannot yet foresee," he said.

This would require resilient institutions, better data, deeper markets, credible safety nets, effective resolution mechanisms and regulation and supervision that are proactive and forward-looking while remaining proportionate, he said.

"If we succeed, financial stability will remain largely invisible, and in central banking, invisibility is perhaps the most invaluable and meaningful measure of success," he added.

Talking about the challenges, Malhotra said rising global debt, stretched AI-linked asset valuations, elevated leverage, private credit and cyber risks as key emerging threats to global financial stability.

He said financial authorities cannot prevent every shock, including those arising from geopolitical events, commodity prices or technological disruptions, but can ensure that the financial system acts as a "shock absorber".

Nestle dairy...

basis," it said, adding, "We have been in continuous engagement with the authorities as per due process established under law and have shared data across other same/similar milk-based products in the category to reflect presence of naturally occurring phosphorus." Last month, FSSAI said it had initiated legal action against Nestle India over non-compliance with food safety norms in the products.

It had examined NAN Excella Pro Stage 1, Lactogen Pro 1 and a follow-up formula, along with promotional material available on e-commerce platforms. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

India summons Pak's CDA over 'facilitation' of illegal infiltration

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 3

India on Saturday summoned Pakistani Chargé d'affaires Saad Warraich to lodge a strong protest over Islamabad's "continued facilitation" of illegal cross-border infiltration.

New Delhi's action came hours after Pakistan summoned the Indian Chargé d'affaires in Islamabad to protest against the "killing of two civilians" by the BSF along the frontier between the two countries in the Punjab sector. BSF troops on Friday shot dead two suspected Pakistani intruders along the international border in Punjab's Tarn Taran district, according to officials.

The Ministry of External Affairs said it summoned the Chargé d'affaires of the Pakistan High Commission to lodge India's strong protest over the "continued facilitation of illegal cross-border infiltration from Pakistan".

India also categorically rejected the baseless and motivated allegations regarding an incident in the Ferozepur sector, Punjab, along the International Border on October 2.

The MEA said the Pakistani side was informed that three individuals infiltrated into Indian territory and, despite multiple warnings by BSF to return to Pakistan, continued to move towards the border fence.

"The BSF was compelled to engage them for posing an imminent security threat.

MP MOVING TOWARDS NEW 'WHITE REVOLUTION': CM

Shah attacks Cong over dairy sector, hails govt's cooperative push

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 3



Union Home minister Amit Shah with Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, in Bhopal, Saturday PTI

Union Home and Cooperation minister Amit Shah on Saturday accused the Congress of failing to establish a separate Ministry of Cooperation during its decades in power and questioned its record on the welfare of cattle farmers and development of the dairy sector.

Addressing a state-level conference of cattle rearers (Gopalak Sammelan) after inaugurating an exhibition on the new criminal laws at Dussehra Ground here, Shah said people associated with agriculture, rural development and cooperatives had sought a dedicated ministry for 75 years, but Congress-led governments did not establish one.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi created the Ministry of Cooperation after assuming office, giving a new direction to the cooperative sector, Shah said.

He said the large turnout of cattle rearers was a positive sign for "White Revolution 2.0" in Madhya Pradesh.

Targeting the Congress over milk production, he said output had risen from 14.6 crore tonnes during the 75 years after Independence to 25 crore tonnes in the last 10 years under Modi's leadership.

He said per capita milk availability had increased from 307 grams per day in 2013-14 to 485 grams, while India had become the world's largest milk producer.

Shah also accused the Congress of spreading "negativity", claiming that the Modi government had raised India's standing across sectors.

He said modern technology was being used to improve cattle breeds and prevent diseases.

During the programme, Shah, in the presence of Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, laid the foundation stone for a Rs 255-crore milk processing plant in Ujjain with a capacity of three lakh litres per day. A Rs 17-crore unit at the Bhopal Milk Union was also inaugurated.

An MoU for urban forest development was exchanged between KRIBHCO and the Madhya Pradesh State Biodiversity Board.

Under the agreement, an urban forest will be developed in Bhopal as part of the Morvan Project.

Earlier, CM Yadav said the state was moving towards a new "White Revolution", with the government aiming to raise milk collection to 50 lakh litres a day by expanding dairy cooperatives.

He said Madhya Pradesh had become the country's third-largest milk-producing state.

He announced the induction of 168 new cow ambulances and competitions for cattle rearers across all 313 blocks, with cash prizes of Rs 1 lakh, Rs 50,000 and Rs 25,000.

Meanwhile, speaking about the new criminal laws, Shah said their full implementation would enable cases to be disposed of within three years, from the filing of an FIR to the Supreme Court.

The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam came into force on July 1, 2024.

Referring to the earlier judicial system's reputation for delays, Shah said the new laws incorporated science and technology into forensic investigations and included provisions concerning women's safety, mob lynching, missing children and terrorism.

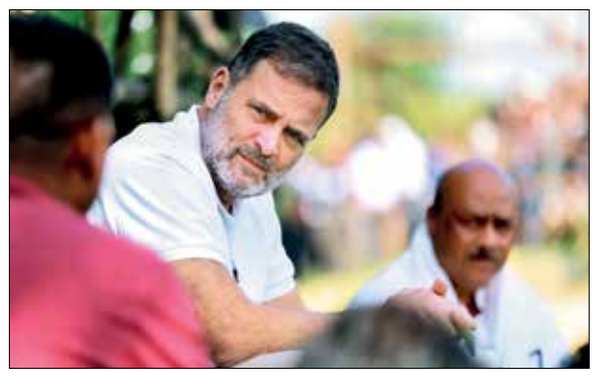
KEY POINTS

- Shah said modern technology was being used to improve cattle breeds and prevent diseases
- CM Yadav said Madhya Pradesh had become the country's third-largest milk-producing state

Will help people where truth is being crushed: Rahul after launching 'Satyagraha' platform

Urges people to register their protests against the govt on platform

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 3



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi interacts with tribal families affected by malnutrition and disease outbreaks, in Balaghat district PTI

BAPU TAUGHT US THAT TRUTH IS OUR GREATEST WEAPON. BUT AN EVEN GREATER WEAPON IS STANDING TOGETHER WITH THE TRUTH

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday alleged that truth is being suppressed and that it was his responsibility to ensure this did not happen, as he launched the 'Satyagraha' digital platform to consolidate issue-based protests unfolding across the country.

He urged people to register their protests against the government on the 'Satyagraha' platform, which he launched a day after the 157th birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi, to ensure help for people "wherever truth was being crushed".

"Across the country, people are fighting for their rights and too often, fighting alone. Gen Z, students, farmers, Adivasis, Dalits, women -- every struggle has its own story. But a lone voice is often easier to silence. "'Satyagraha' is an initiative to bring these voices together on one map," he said in a post on X.

Invoking Mahatma, the Congress MP said, "Bapu taught us that truth is our greatest weapon. But an even greater weapon is standing together with the truth. If you too are fighting against any injustice, share your story. It will take just two minutes."

Gandhi said their protest will find a place on the Satyagraha map, adding, "You will see who else, like you, is fighting their own battle".

"And I will do whatever I can - in Parliament, on the streets, through letters, wherever I am needed - to stand with you. As the leader of the Opposition, that is my responsibility. Tell me the story of your Satyagraha...," he said.

In a video posted along with it, the Raebareli MP said, "As you all know, truth is being suppressed all across the country, and there are multiple protests happening across the country."

Meeting with PM was historic and inspiring, says CM Saini



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini along with ministers and MLAs, in a group photograph with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi MPOST

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 3

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that the meeting of the state's ministers and MLAs with Prime Minister Narendra Modi was historic and inspiring.

The Prime Minister provided important guidance regarding Haryana's development, public service and organisation. The guidance of PM Modi is our resolve, which all of us will work to implement on the ground. Chief Minister Saini was addressing a press conference at Haryana Bhawan in New Delhi on Saturday after meeting Prime Minister.

He said that the PM provided clear guidance on further strengthening Haryana's association with the resolve of a Viksit Bharat.

He expressed confidence that all ministers and MLAs would work to implement the Prime Minister's words on the ground in their respective areas and in the interest of the people of Haryana.

He said that Modi's guidance is Haryana's resolve. The mantra given by the Prime Minister is our resolve. Now, every minister will work to take this thinking to the ground in his or her department, every MLA in his or her Assembly constituency and every worker in his or her village.

'Youth getting over-age waiting for recruitments'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 3

Former Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda has expressed deep concern over the rising unemployment in Haryana.

He said that the unemployment rate in the state has crossed 15.4 per cent, while the rural unemployment rate has reached 17.5 per cent. These figures are much higher than those of several backward and major states in the country.

'More worrying is the fact that the government is not taking any steps to control unemployment. Far from providing jobs, the government has not even been able to conduct the Common Eligibility Test (CET). Young people are becoming over-age while waiting for the CET and recruitments,' Hooda further said.

Hooda said that the BJP had come to power after promising to provide 2 lakh permanent jobs. But so far, this government has not conducted any recruitment through the Haryana Staff Selection Commission. In the few recruitments conducted through the Haryana Public Service Commission, an additional criterion of 35 per cent was deliberately added, leaving most of the posts vacant.

Even among the handful of posts for which recruitment was conducted, candidates from other states were given preference over those from Haryana.

Narco-trafficking kingpin deported from Türkiye

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 3

India has successfully deported alleged narco-trafficking kingpin Navpreet Singh from Türkiye following which Union Home minister Amit Shah termed the operation as a great success for the government in its efforts towards curbing the menace of drug mafia.

As per Shah, the accused which was given Turkish citizenship under the name of Navab Virk was involved in smuggling heroin and methamphetamine from Afghanistan to India.

Indian agencies tracked him down and with the help of Turkish authorities, he was deported and brought back to India where he has been detained in connection with cases pertaining to drug trafficking and other alleged crimes.

CM Mann says 'kaam ki rajneeti' has won trust of people

'Punjab to recruit 10,000 new police personnel'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 3



Bhagwant Mann MPOST

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said Punjab is now seeing a clear contrast between "Kaam Ki Rajneeti" and the family-centric politics of the past.

During a massive Lok Milni at Ghanie Ke Bangar in Fatehgarh Churian, the Chief Minister highlighted free electricity for 90 per cent of households, treatment up to Rs 10 lakh, canal water for 88 per cent of agricultural land and direct financial assistance to mothers and sisters, saying his government had focused on taking the benefits of governance directly to the people.

The Chief Minister pointed out that in just four-and-a-half years, his government had delivered more work than the 22 years of Congress and Akali rule, while the transformation of government schools had taken Punjab to the top position in education.

Pointing to the overwhelming response during the public survey at the gathering, he said the people's message was clear ahead of 2027.

Taking to X, CM Bhagwant Singh Mann stated: "Today, the love and enthusiasm shown by the people of Majha who gathered for a massive public meeting at Ghanie Ke Bangar village in Fatehgarh Churian constituency was truly overwhelming. The traditional parties looted Punjab in the name of 'me and my family', but we have worked with honesty and integrity, providing free electricity to 90 per cent of households, free treatment up to Rs 10 lakh, canal water to farmers' fields, and direct financial assistance to mothers and sisters. It is because of these policies that Punjab has today emerged as the number one state in the country in education."

Meanwhile, CM Mann on Saturday also announced 10,000 new recruitments in the Punjab Police to root out drugs, as he declared that the state is fighting the final and decisive 'Yudh Nashean Virudh'.

UTTAR PRADESH ASSEMBLY ELECTIONS

Unity, keeping alliance with SP intact key tasks for Cong leadership

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, October 3

Unity in its ranks and a smooth alliance with the Samajwadi Party (SP) ahead of the 2027 state polls are the two major tasks that await the new Congress leadership in Uttar Pradesh, party leaders feel.

On Friday, the Congress effected a leadership change in the party's state unit, replacing Ajay Rai, a Bhumihar, with Aradhana Misra-Mona, a Brahmin. The party also brought in its firebrand Saharanpur MP Imran Masood as working president, apparently to broaden its reach in western Uttar Pradesh, where BJP has teamed up with the Rashtriya Lok Dal.

Rai has been among the most visible party faces in the state over the past three years. The new Mona-Masood team will have to ensure that the party doesn't come across as a divided house ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh polls.

The outgoing Uttar Pradesh Congress chief on Saturday thanked the party leadership for giving him the responsibility of leading the party in the state.

"I will remain eternally grateful to @RahulGandhi ji and the top leadership of the Congress for entrusting an ordinary worker like me with the responsibility of the Uttar Pradesh Congress Committee president. The fight continues," he said in Hindi on X.

Rai, who became the UPCC chief in August 2023, has already bared his plan of contesting the 2027 UP polls from Pindra Assembly segment of Varanasi. Party sources said Rai was not too keen on an alliance with the Samajwadi Party.

The electoral graph of the Congress -- the grand old party of India -- has been in constant decline in the state since 1989, when it last held power there.

LOST & FOUND

I, Rahul Kukreja S/o Late Kirpal Singh Kukreja R/o H.No.7, Sector 15, Faridabad have Lost Original Sale Certificate of dated 11.09.1961, executed by Assistant Settlement Officer, Office of the Regional Settlement Commissioner New Delhi in favour of Sh. Atma Ram S/o Sh. Tola Ramin respect to H.No. 205, area measuring 238 sq. yards, situated at N.I.T. Faridabad, Tehsil Badkhal, District, 2 Original Registered Sale Deed no. 1824 dated 27.01.1965 registered with S.R. Ballabgarh executed by Sh. Atma Ram S/o Sh. Tola Ramin favour of Sh. Jaswant Singh S/o Sardar Sohan Singh in respect to H.No. 205, area measuring 238 sq. yards, situated at N.I.T. Faridabad, Tehsil Badkhal, District Faridabad and 3. Original Registered Conveyance Deed document no. 10728 dated 24.11.1988 registered with S.R. Faridabad executed by Tehsildar (Sales) Managing Officer Faridabad in favour of Sh. Satish Kumar Lamba S/o Sh. Sant Ramin respect to Adjacent Land to H.No. 1-B/205, area measuring 170 sq. yards, situated at N.I.T. Faridabad, Tehsil Badkhal, Distr

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, का कार्यालय,रॉची

ज्ञापांक.–...../र0का0, रॉची दिनांक :–

अति आवश्यक सूचना

एतद द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि रॉची जिलाबल के निलंबित आ0/3275 शशिकांत तिर्की पे0 स्व0 नोबेल तिर्की, ग्राम–मेहा (छोटका टोली) पोस्ट+थाना–कर्रा, जिला खुंटी वर्तमान ग्राम हरचण्डा पो0–डडु थाना ओरमांझी ,जिला रॉची ,दिनांक 19.03.2019 से बिना किसी सूचना/अनुमति के अपने कर्तव्य से फरार हो गये हैं। जिस आरोप में रॉची जिला वि0कार्य0 सं0 241/2020 संचालित किया गया है। आरक्षी श्री तिर्की को वर्तमान घर के पता पर पुलिस पदाधिकारी भेजकर कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित होने एवं अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित करने हेतु पत्र हस्तगत कराया गया है। उसके बावजूद भी न तो अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित किये न ही अभी तक अपने कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित हुए हैं।

समाचार पत्र के माध्यम से आपको अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित करने हेतु अंतिम अवसर देते हुए सूचित किया जाता है कि 15 दिनों के अन्दर अपने कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित हों अन्यथा संचालित वि0का0 में एकतरफा निर्णय ले लिया जायेगा।

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
रॉची

PR 391045 Police (26-27) D"

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Bhoranj Division HPPWD, Bhoranj on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Item rate/ Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table:-.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated cost (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Starting date for down-loading Bid	Deadline for submission of Bid
1	Construction of Medical Block , Emergency ward along with Operation theatre at PHC Jahu in Tehsil Bhoranj Distt Hamirpur (SH:- Part –I Civil works i.e Building portion , WS & SI , Septic tank, Rain Water Harvesting tank, Boundary wall and Gate) Part II Electrical works i.e (Providing E-I, 1 No lift therein)	5,40,11,001/-	10,80,200/-	06-10-2026	13-10-2026

The bidders are advised to note all details of tenders, from the department website .

Executive Engineer
Bhoranj Division , HPPWD Bhoranj, Pin Code 176045
Tel. No. 01972-266099 e-mail : eepwd-bhoranj-hp@gov.in
on behalf of Governor of HP

Ro.No 3870/2026-2027 HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
SHER-I-KASHMIR INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
SOURA, SRINAGAR, J&K (INDIA)-190011
ammoimports@skims.ac.in, Fax No: 0194-2403404
e-NIT NO: SIMS -324-eNIT-25-(Imports) of 2026
DATED:29/09/2026

Subject: -Abbreviated Notice inviting e-tenders for supply of Consumables for Emergency Vascular Procedures in Head and Body Trauma, Cancer Care, aneurysm Coiling and Stroke Management for the Department of Radio-Diagnosis & Imaging SKIMS.

For and on behalf of Lt Governor Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir, e-tenders under two bid system are invited through Director Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences, Soura, Srinagar from Original Manufacturers OR their Indian subsidiaries or Authorized local dealer for supply ofConsumables for Emergency Vascular Procedures in Head and Body Trauma, Cancer Care, aneurysm Coiling and Stroke Management for the Department of Radio-Diagnosis & Imaging SKIMS on one year rate contract basis to be reckoned from the date of allotment of rate contractt. The detailed tender document is available on **www.jktenders.gov.in** as per following:

Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Tender Fee	Last Date of Submission of online bids	Opening of Technical Bids	Last Date of Clarification
Rs.600000.00	Rs.2500.00	22.10.2026	30.10.2026	07.10.2026.

No clarification/representation shall be entertained after the expiry of last date of clarification.
Complete bidding process will be done online on e-tender portal **www.jktenders.gov.in** & the tenders should be submitted strictly in accordance with the provisions of the detailed NIT. No Proposal will be accepted in physical form. The tender documents are available on SKIMS website **www.skims.ac.in** for reference only.

No: SIMS-324-eNIT-25-(Imports)-2026-1803-09 Sd/-
Dated:29.09.2026 Materials Management Officer
DIP No:DIPK-NB-1789/26 Imports, SKIMS

News at a glance

Road crash kills 20 people in Nigeria's Plateau state

ABUJA: A multi-vehicle crash killed at least 20 people in Nigeria's north-central state of Plateau, the road agency said Saturday.

The crash involved four vehicles on Friday, and preliminary findings indicate brake failure was the likely cause, the Federal Road Safety Commission said. The crash occurred along the Hawan Kibo-Jos route, a major thoroughfare connecting Plateau to Abuja. Road accidents are frequent in Africa's most populous country, in part due to poor road conditions and lax enforcement of traffic laws.

Latvians vote for new parliament

RIGA: Latvians are electing a new parliament on Saturday as pro-Ukraine Prime Minister Andris Kulbergs seeks a full term.

The vote comes as the small republic on NATO's eastern flank contends with growing concern about potential Russian aggression.

A political crisis in May over the handling of stray drones suspected to be from Ukraine brought down the governing coalition that had been under strain due to multiple other issues. Kulbergs, 47, is now seeking his own mandate from voters.

Pak: Five militants killed in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

PESHAWAR: Security forces killed five militants in an intelligence-based operation in the restive Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan, an official said on Saturday.

Several militant hideouts belonging to Fitna al-Khawarij were targeted and destroyed during the operation, carried out based on intelligence information in the South Waziristan district, the official said. The federal government uses the term 'Fitna al Khwarij' for the banned terror outfit Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP).



Palestinians inspect the site of an early morning Israeli airstrike in Gaza city, Saturday AP/PTI

North Korea says it test-fired an intermediate-range missile

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Seoul, October 3

North Korea said Saturday it test-fired an intermediate-range ballistic missile that it claimed has manoeuvrable flight capabilities designed to evade missile defences in South Korea and Japan.

The latest test comes amid heightened tensions between the two Koreas over border land mine blasts.

Kim Yo Jong, the powerful sister of North Korean leader Kim Jong Un, said her brother supervised the test of the missile, which she described as strategic, implying it was designed to deliver nuclear weapons.

She also said it could change its flight trajectory at low altitudes and was equipped with unspecified artificial intelligence capabilities that she claimed would make it highly difficult to intercept.

MOTIVE FOR ATTACK REMAINS UNCLEAR

Flydubai cockpit attack: Reports identify co-pilot as Omani citizen

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New York, October 3

An Omani citizen, Hamam al-Hammami, has been identified as the flydubai co-pilot who attacked Indian Captain Smit Machchhar and allegedly attempted to take control of a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight this week, according to US media reports.

Al-Hammami was reportedly barred from flying previously in Oman over concerns about his radical ideological views, the Wall Street Journal reported on Saturday, quoting people familiar with the matter.

On flydubai flight FZ1073, he attacked Machchhar with a crash axe, typically kept in the cockpit for use in emergencies, seriously injuring him on Wednesday. The captain fought back and managed to open the cockpit door, enabling passengers to overpower the attacker.

The motive for the attack remains unclear.

The UAE, which is leading the investigation, said on Saturday it was probing whether the incident was linked to any "terrorist activity or purpose".

Several other news publications, including CNN, identified Al-Hammani by name. But officials have not yet disclosed his identity.

The flight, carrying 174 passengers, transmitted emergency signals and made a rapid descent of more than 17,000 feet from 34,000 feet before safely landing by two reserved pilots at Prince Sultan Bin Abdulaziz Airport in Saudi Arabia's Tabuk city, where al-Hammami was taken into custody.

"The alleged attacker is an Omani national named Hamam al-Hammami," the WSJ report said.

CNN, citing two sources and an Israeli official, identified the pilot as Omani citizen Hamam al-Hammami. He was born in the UAE to an Omani father and a Syrian mother and has spent several years of his life in the UAE, it said.

CNN cited another source, a regional diplomat, saying al-Hammami was removed from flight training because of concerns over his radical views and was subsequently given another role at Oman's national airline.



A FlyDubai aircraft carrying Israelis who experienced an emergency landing in Saudi Arabia arrives at Ben Gurion International Airport, near Tel Aviv, Israel AP/PTI

Russian attacks kill 6 in Ukraine, damage Kyiv's Northern Bridge

Russia's Defence Ministry confirmed it was behind the latest attack

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 3

Russian attacks in Ukraine killed at least six people and damaged Kyiv's Northern Bridge, suspending traffic and causing tailbacks for a third day in Moscow's latest effort to disrupt life in the Ukrainian capital.

The strike came after two days of Russian assaults forced the full or partial closure of three of Kyiv's six road bridges over the Dnipro River. Previously, Russia has hit apartment blocks, supermarket warehouses, gas stations and data centres, among other targets.

Russia invaded its neighbour more than 4 and half years ago, and there are no concrete signs that a peace settlement might be possible. Fighting along the roughly 1,250-kilometre (780-mile) front line snaking through northern, eastern and southern Ukraine has been virtually deadlocked in recent months.

Kyiv Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said the strike on the bridge damaged the road surface and trolleybus cables, forcing traffic to be suspended. There were no casualties reported.



Rescue workers clear the rubble from a residential house damaged in a Russian strike on Kharkiv AP/PTI

SPORT

INDIA HAD THEIR MOMENTS BUT WERE UNABLE TO FIND GOAL

India fight gallantly but Brazil cruise to 4-0 win in FIFA friendly

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, October 3

India fought gallantly for initial 25 minutes but five-time champions Brazil showed the vast gulf between the teams with a neatly executed 4-0 win in their FIFA international friendly here on Saturday.

Carlo Ancelotti's new-look side, which is in a rebuilt mode post their pre-quarterfinal exit in the World Cup 2026, largely played within themselves without injecting much pace in their historic friendly.

India, backed by a crowd that swelled to 51,402, had their moments in the first 25 minutes but were unable to find the goal.

Estevao (28th minute), Pedro (42nd) and Samuel Lino (58th, 90+5th) scored for the South Americans, who controlled the game without hitting top gear.

Coming off a gritty 1-1 draw against 44th-ranked Panama, India quickly found themselves up against an opposition, who played at a vastly different level.

Yet, Khalid Jamil's side competed with them.

Jamil made two changes from the Panama game, bringing in experienced midfielders Anirudh Thapa and Sahal Abdul Samad for Apuia and Ricky Shabong.

Thapa made an immediate impact, clearing a dangerous low cross after Vinicius Jr was sent clear on the left in the second minute.

The intervention drew a huge cheer from the home crowd.

India continued to frustrate Brazil in the early stages as Manvir Singh provided an outlet on the left, while Ryan Williams and Ashique Kuruniyan looked to exploit space on the counter.

Manvir had a chance to break clear, only for Marquinhos to make a crucial recovery run and take the ball away.

At the other end, Vinicius was Brazil's main threat and the Real Madrid star twice tested Gurpreet Singh Sandhu, including with a shot after dancing past Abhishek Singh, but the Indian goalkeeper was equal to the first effort.

Ancelotti had made several changes to the side with Pedro Morisco replacing usual goalkeeper and Mauro Junior, while Gabriel Bontempo, Andrey Santos and Matheuzinho were among those given a chance.

Vinicius, Pedro and Estevao formed the front three in a 4-3-3 formation.

Brazil eventually broke India's resistance when Estevao collected the ball on the edge of the box, twisted past Ashique and fired towards the near post.

Gurpreet Singh Sandhu got a hand to the powerful effort but could not keep it out. Pedro then struck the post with a header as Brazil began finding more space.

Brazil doubled the lead when Estevao picked out Pedro's run behind the Indian defence. Pedro's shot appeared within Gurpreet's reach but squirmed under his palm into the net, leaving India 0-2 down at half-time.

After the break, Jamil replaced Gurpreet, handing East Bengal's Prabhsukhan Singh Gill his debut.

Brazil also introduced Bruno Guimaraes, Gabriel Magalhaes, Vanderson, Endrick, Gabriel Martinelli and Douglas Luiz.

India had chances, with Manvir Singh forcing a save and Williams seeing an effort cleared off the line. However, Brazil punished another mistake in the 58th minute when Bijoy's loose pass allowed Samuel Lino to race into the box and curl the ball into the bottom corner.

Lino completed his brace with a low, powerful strike that went through Gill's outstretched hand. Brazil threatened to add more, with Endrick creating a chance for Guimaraes and Bruno later finding Breno Bidon, though the latter was flagged offside.

India continued to seek a consolation goal. Williams combined with Manvir, who also hit the post from a narrow angle, but Brazil's defence held firm to complete a 4-0 win.



KEY POINTS

- Estevao (28th minute), Pedro (42nd) and Samuel Lino (58th, 90+5th) scored for the South Americans, who controlled the game without hitting top gear
- India continued to frustrate Brazil in the early stages as Manvir Singh provided an outlet on the left, while Ryan Williams and Ashique Kuruniyan looked to exploit space on the counter
- The breakthrough finally came when Estevao picked up the ball on the edge of the box, twisted past Ashique and fired towards the near post. Gurpreet got a hand to the powerful kick but could not keep it out

Pranavi becomes 1st Indian woman golfer to strike gold at Asian Games

Pranavi's performance also became a crucial factor in fetching India the team silver

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Nagoya, October 3

Pranavi Urs on Saturday became the first Indian woman golfer to win a gold medal in the Asian Games, holding on to a slender one-stroke lead in the final round to achieve the historic feat that also helped the country claim the team silver.

The 23-year-old from Mysore sent in three birdies to recover from a horrendous triple bogey on the third hole, which had wiped away her three-stroke overnight lead.

With a final round score of even-par 70, she ended with a total of 15-under 265 for four days, a stroke ahead of the pack. The silver went to China's Yin Ruoning (67) and bronze was taken by Singapore's Shannon Tan (68) following a playoff after both ended with overall scores of 266 in what was a tense finish for the top three.

"I like being the first to do things. People will come along to do more but the first will always be the first," a jubilant Pranavi said after the historic triumph.

Pranavi's performance, that included birdies on the 6th, 10th and 13th holes in the final round, also became a crucial factor in fetching India the team silver with other members being Aditi Ashok (67 in final round) and Diksha Dagar (77 in final round).

Olympian Aditi, who had won an individual silver in the last edition of the Games, produced her best performance of the week, slamming in five consecutive birdies against a double bogey and a bogey, to sign off tied 14th individually with a two-over 282 total. Diksha ended tied 23rd on the individual leaderboard with a 12-over total. The two best scores are taken into account for deciding the team medals and India ended 14-under 546, well behind gold-winners China (22-under 538).

The trio thus ensured the best ever performance by an Indian women's golf team at the Asian Games.

Pranavi's medal was India's first golfing gold since the 2002 men's individual top honours bagged by Shiv Kapur.

It was also the best Indian performance since the 1982 Delhi Asiad, the year in which golf became a part of the Games roster.

In that edition, Lakshman Singh had bagged the individual men's gold, and joined Amit Luthra, and Rajiv Mohta to bag the team honours as well.

Kapil Dev, President, DP World PGTI, and Amandeep Johl, CEO, DP World PGTI, congratulated Pranavi Urs on her historic triumph at the Asian Games, where she secured India's first-ever individual gold medal in women's golf. The Indian women's team comprising Pranavi Urs, Aditi Ashok and Diksha Dagar also created history by winning the silver medal in the team event on Saturday.

DP World PGTI President Kapil Dev congratulated Pranavi Urs on winning the women's individual gold and the women's team of Pranavi Urs, Aditi Ashok and Diksha Dagar on securing silver at the Asian Games. "Pranavi's gold and our women's team's silver are moments of immense pride for India and Indian golf," he said.

DP World Professional Golf Tour of India CEO Sri Amandeep Johl hailed Pranavi Urs' gold and the women's team silver at the Asian Games. "Pranavi Urs has delivered a remarkable performance... and her historic gold medal is a proud moment for Indian golf," he said, adding that Pranavi, Aditi Ashok & Diksha Dagar's achievements would inspire the next generation of Indian golfers.



Pranavi Urs

WITH A FINAL ROUND SCORE OF EVEN-PAR 70, SHE ENDED WITH A TOTAL OF 15-UNDER 265 FOR FOUR DAYS, A STROKE AHEAD OF THE PACK

Shai Hope leads West Indies to 5-wicket win over India in 3rd ODI



Shai Hope

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mullanpur, October 3

Skipper Shai Hope scored an unbeaten 162 off 143 balls as West Indies beat India by five wickets in the third and final ODI here on Saturday.

It was a consolation for the West Indies after India sealed the three-match series with wins in the first two games.

KL Rahul (129 not out), Rohit Sharma (92) and Ruturaj Gaikwad (55) contributed to India's 351/7.

Hope led the West Indies' chase and stayed till the end to get the job done in 48.2 overs. Amir Jangoo (67) and Keemo Paul (44) also contributed to the win. It was also the visitors' highest chase in ODIs.

Brief Scores:

India 351/7 in 50 overs (KL Rahul 129 not out, Rohit Sharma 92, Ruturaj Gaikwad 57; Jayden Seales 3/62). West Indies 352/5 in 48.2 overs (Shai Hope 162 not out, Amir Jangoo 67; Kuldeep Yadav 1/62).

GOVERNMENTOFJAMMU &KASHMIR
OFFICEOFTHEMATERIALSMANAGEMENTOFFICER(Imports)
SHER- I-KASHMIR INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, SOURA-190011
Email:ammoimports@skims.ac.in,Fax:0194-2403403
e-NITNO:SIMS-324-eNIT-26-(Imports)of2026
DATED:01/10/2026

Subject: -Abbreviated Notice invitinge-tenders for supply of various Laboratory Reagents &Chemicals at SKIMS Soura, Srinagar on one year rate contract basis.

For and on behalf of Lt. Governor of Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir, e- tender under two bid system are invited through Director Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences from Original Manufacturers/ their authorized distributors/ dealers forsupplyofvariouslaboratory reagents andchemicals, at SKIMS Soura on one year rate contract basisto be reckoned from the date of allotment of rate contract.

The detailed tender document is available on **www.jktenders.gov.in** & on SKIMS website **www.skims.ac.in** & the NIT schedule is as following:

Last Date for submission of online bids	05/11/2026 upto 04:00 Pm
Opening of technical bids	13/11/2026 at 02:00 Pm
Last date for submission of original tender fee and EMD document	One day before opening of technical bid.

Complete bidding process will be onlineo ne-tender portal **www.jktenders.gov.in** & the tenders should be submitted strictly in accordance with the provisions of the detailed NIT.

No:SIMS-324-eNIT-26-(Imports)of2026-1822 - 28 **Sd/-**
Dated: 01/10/2026 **Materials Management Officer**
DIP No:DIPK-NB-1791/26 **Imports, SKIMS**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prince Kumar S/o Panchal Sah R/o Vikky ka Makaan, Road No.6, Mahipalpur, Vasant Kunj North, South-West,Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 120/2022 U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act, P.S. Vasant Kunj North, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prince Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prince Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Prince Kumar** of case **FIR No. 120/2022 U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act, P.S. Vasant Kunj North, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Animesh Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No. 32, Lok-Up Building
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/14089/SW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Charanjeet Singh @ Himanshu @ Chilka S/o** Satnam Singh **R/o** H.No. 170, 3rd Floor, Bharat Nagar Society, Bharat Nagar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 1055/2023 U/s 394/397/411/34 IPC**., has been registered at **PS: Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Charanjeet Singh @ Himanshu @ Chilka** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Charanjeet Singh Himanshu @ Chilka** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Charanjeet Singh @ Himanshu @ Chilka** under **FIR No. 1055/2023 U/s 394/397/411/34 IPC**., registered at **PS: Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Vandana
Ld. ASJ-02
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14045/ON/2026
(court notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Manjish Gupta S/o Kanhaiya Gupta R/o Kh No. 338, Mandir Ke Pas, Ghoga Narela Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 386/2021 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Manjish Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manjish Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manjish Gupta** of case **FIR No. 386/2021 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi.** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-05, North
Room No. 114, First Floor
Rohini Court Delhi,

DP/14057/ON/26 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vikas Kumar, S/o Arjun Prajapati, R/o H.No. 174, Singhalpur Village, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 421/2018, U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vikas Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vikas Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vikas Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 421/2018, U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.11.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14078/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shabnam Nigar, W/o. Gulam Rasool, R/o. H.No.7, Rajeev Nagar Extn., Begumpur, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide Case **FIR No.737/2016 U/S 324 IPC** registered at **P.S Begumpur, District Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Shabnam Nigar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shabnam Nigar** is absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shabnam Nigar**, accused of Case **FIR No.737/2016 U/S 324 IPC, P.S Begumpur, District Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026.**

By Order Ms. Anuradha Jindal,
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
North-West, Room No.101, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/14074/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. DGN/83of 2026-27 Dated 01-10-2026

For and on behalf of theLieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmire-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completeon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Last Lane of Nidesh Vihar Sainik Colony Extension from the H/o Imran Khan behind RM Public School near the H/o Gagan Gupta (Under Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	20.00	600	40000 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	01 Month	(1200 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	"A" ' "B" & "C" Class
2	Up-gradation of road from Toyota Showroom, Narwal to Paradise Avenue Residential Welfare Association, Narwal Bala near Vidhata Nagar (Under Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	20.00	600	40000 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	01 Month	(1200 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	"A" ' "B" & "C" Class

Position of AAA:- **Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu vide order No. 105 of 2026 dated 07-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 20.00 Lacs for item No. 1 & 2 respectively.**
Position of TS:- **Sanctioned by this office vide order No. 89/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 29-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 20.00 Lacs for item No. 1 and order No. 91/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 29-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 20.00 Lacs for item No. 2.**
Project Authority:- **Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu.**
Major Head of Account :- Under Capex Budget 2026-27.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website **http://jktenders.gov.in** as per below schedule

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	01-10-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From01-10-2026 to 12-10-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	06-10-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	01-10-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	12-10-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	13-10-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Special Condition :-
(i) Security deposit shall be deposited by the contractor within 10 days of issuance of LOI, failing which the concerned tender issuing authority shall forfeit the EMD and recommended contractor for blacklisting and issue a fresh tender forthwith.
(ii) The contractor shall initiate the work within 10 days of entering into the agreement, failing which the concerned Executive Engineer shall terminate the contract and issue a fresh tender after imposing penalties viz. forfeit security/LD as per T&C of the BID document and recommended contractor for blacklisting.
(iii) The work shall be completed by the concerned contractor as per the timeline stipulated in BID document/agreement, failing which action shall be initiated against contractor by forfeiting EMD and shall be recommended for blacklisting

Sd/- ((Er. Karanjeet Singh)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division, Gandhi Nagar

DIP No:DIP/J-11656/26

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
SH. PARMINDER SINGH
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Mahendergarh
Jaswant Singh & Ors.
Vs.
General Public of India
CNR No. HRNRA0-000636-2025
CS-522-2025
Next Date:- 22-12-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
Defendant: General Public of India
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **22-12-2026** at **10:00 am.**
For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district notice & district = Mahendragarh**
Sd/- SH. PARMINDER SINGH
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Dated 30-09.2026 Mahendergarh

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), City Civil Court , BAHADURGARH
State Bank of India through Sanjay Dhingra
Vs.
Omkari
CASENO.RSUIT/82/2021
CNR No. HRJRA0-000299-2021
Next Date 03-12-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
1. Sudesh
2. BIMLA BOTH D/O Jai Singh S/o Sh. Surat Singh R/o Village Jardakpur, Tehsil Bahadurgarh Distt Jhajjar at present Rs/o A-3/153, Sector -5, Rohini, North West, Delhi
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **03-12-2026** at **10:00 am.**
For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district = Jhajjar**
Sd/- Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), City Civil Court , dated 03-10-2026 BAHADURGARH

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav S/o Sh. Bharat Yadav R/o H. No. 244, Gali No.17, Block-B, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 31/2012 U/S 33 (1)A Delhi Excise Act, PS Alipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dashrath @ Raj Yadav** of **FIR No. 31/2012 U/S 33 (1)A Delhi Excise Act, PS Alipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **02.11.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot
Chief Judicial Magistrate
North, Court No.115, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14064/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Alka Naiyr**, **W/o.** Sh. Ashwani Naiyr, **R/o:** H.No. WZ-9, Sukhram Park, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 1245/2019, U/s: 498A/406/34/354/511/323 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Sultan Puri, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Alka Naiyr** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Alka Naiyr** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Alka Naiyr, FIR No.: 1245/2019, U/s: 498A/406/34/354/511/323 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Sultan Puri, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Neha Goel
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-02, Room No: 18
North West, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14033/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Amit S/o Late Braham Pal Singh Tomar** & **Sheela Devi W/o Late Braham Pal Singh Tomar** both **R/o H. No. A-69, Gali No.10, Mange Ram Park, Prahladpur Road (Near Pooth Kalan) Delhi-86. Mob.: 9311324828 / 9210316535** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 116/2016 U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Najafgarh, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Amit** & **Sheela Devi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Amit** & **Sheela Devi** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Amit & Sheela Devi** of **FIR No. 116/2016 U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Najafgarh, New Delhi** are required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **05.11.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court-03, South West District, Room No.312
District Court Dwarka, New Delhi

DP/14016/DW/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Abhishek, S/o. Daya Ram, R/o. N-28, D-502, Wazirpur Industrial Area, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.219/2024 U/S 279/337 IPC** registered at **P.S. Moti Nagar, West District, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Abhishek** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Abhishek** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Abhishek**, accused of **FIR No. 219/2024 U/S 279/337 IPC, P.S. Moti Nagar, West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026.**

By Order, Anshul Singhal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
Room No.268, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/ 14042/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE No. T-18-N-2026-27 **Date : 28.09.2026**

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N.C.Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No. : T-18-N-2026-27	**Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 8962621.00**

Name of work with its location & Completion Period : Electrical work in connection with "Replacement of old and defective DG sets for emergency supply at Running Rooms at MTJ."

Completion period : 12 months

• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** • Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:00** hrs on **23.10.2026** **2240/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. : AGC/TRD/T/2026/31 **E-TENDER NOTICE** Date: 30.09.2026

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No. : AGCTRDT202631

Name of work : Provision of Electrical AT for EI in lieu of relay Based Signalling gears in AGC - KXM section of Agra Division.

Approximate Cost : Rs. 76,15,562.50	**Earnest Money :** Rs. 15,23,000/-
Period of completion : Nine months	

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in. 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to **15:30** Hrs. on date **23.10.2026** **2242/26 (PH)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Mohin Qureshi S/o Mukhtar Ahmad R/o H. No. RZ 3030 Gali No. 34 Infront of Majidia Hospital Gali No. 06 Tuglakabad Extension New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR 312/2023 U/s 420/468/506/120B/34 IPC PS: Sangam Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohin Qureshi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohin Qureshi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohin Qureshi** accused of **FIR 312/2023 U/s 420/468/506/120B/34 IPC PS: Sangam Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Chatinder Singh
JMFC-04 Room No. 211
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/13798/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd Amir @ Raja, S/o:** Mohd Shakir, **R/o:** J3/172 Gali No. 01 Anar Wali Masjid, Kishan Kunj, Laxmi Nagar Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 131/2019 U/s 392/411/34 IPC P.S.: Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd Amir @ Raja,**cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd Amir @ Raja,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd Amir @ Raja,** accused of **FIR No.: 131/2019 U/s 392/411/34 IPC P.S.: Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
JMFC-03 Court No. 16 East District,
Karkardooma Court Delhi

DP/13782/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sunita Panday R/o H. No. 113, Gurjar Wali Gali, Chandan Holla, New Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 127/2018 U/S 447/465/466/504/34 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunita Panday** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunita Panday** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunita Panday** accused of **Case FIR No. 127/2018 U/S 447/465/466/504/34 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shivli Talwar
JMFC-01, Room No-214
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/13778/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **(1) Naaemaka Agbo @ Frank S/o Uwadilachi R/o H. No. 151, C-Block, Raju Park, Devli Road, Khanpur, Delhi (2) Kingsley Ndukwa @ Son S/o Ndukwa R/o H. No. A-16A Raju Park, Devli Road, Khanpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 189/2017 U/S 420/467/468/471/120B IPC & 14(a) The foreigners Act, 1946 PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **(1) Naaemaka Agbo @ Frank (2) Kingsley Ndukwa @ Son** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **(1) Naaemaka Agbo @ Frank (2) Kingsley Ndukwa @ Son** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **(1) Naaemaka Agbo @ Frank (2) Kingsley Ndukwa @ Son** accused of **FIR No. 189/2017 U/S 420/467/468/471/120B IPC & 14(a) The foreigners Act, 1946 PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Kartik Taparia
JMFC-06, Room No. 247
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13761/N/2026
(Court Matter)

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

(CONSTRUCTION / ROAD SAFETY PROJECTS)

E-Tender Notice No. CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-07-2026, DATED: 27.09.2026

For and on behalf of The President of India, The Deputy Chief Engineer, Construction, Road Safety Projects, Southern Railway, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 invites e-tender for the following work(s) as per Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) in our portal **www.ireps.gov.in.** The tenderers / Contractors intending to apply for the tender needs to get enrolled in the portal **www.ireps.gov.in** and only online tenders will be accepted.

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Cash Value (₹)	Closing Date @ 15.00 Hrs
1	Salem Division: Rebuilding of 3 Nos (Br. No.SGE-13, SGE-42 and SGE-48) of RCC Slab Aqueduct / ROB in ED-SGE Section.	172822483/-	19/10/2026
2	i) Salem Division: Rebuilding of 3 Nos (Br. No.SGE-40,SGE-43 and SGE-47 of RCC Slab Aqueduct / ROB in ED-SGE Section. ii) Salem Division - Erode - Karur Section - Proposed Construction of Road Over Bridge in Lieu of Existing LC No.: 5 at km 5/400-500 1x36.0m Effective Span Composite Girder Between Erode and Pasur Stations Along with Pedestrian Subway.	300530596/-	19/10/2026
3	Palakkad Division - Shoranur - Palakkad section - Proposed construction of Road Over Bridge in lieu of LC No. 156 at km 523/600-700 in between Kanjikode & Palakkad Stations (Moruglass Gate)	81346997/-	19/10/2026

For further details, please refer to website portal **www.ireps.gov.in** or contact Office of the Chief Administrative Officer, Construction, Road Safety Projects, Southern Railway, E.V.R. High Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008.

Deputy Chief Engineer, Construction,
Road Safety Projects, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008.

Sold, Signed, Forgotten



India wants more people to buy insurance. But when commissions become the only driving force, the industry risks turning protection into just another profit target. And customers discover the mess only when they reach out with claims

MPOST BUREAU

"Sir, you should seriously consider this." That was how the conversation began. And it was not unusual. A customer had walked into his bank to discuss his financials. He had some savings, a few investments and a family to take care of. The relationship manager (RM) knew enough about him to make the conversation sound personal.

They suddenly discussed an insurance policy. Charts. Tax benefits. Projected returns. Numbers that were reassuring. There was even a story about financial security, another about what would happen to the family if something happened to him. The customer listened. He trusted the RM. He signed. The premium was debited. The policy was issued. The RM congratulated him.

But soon, the RM stopped taking calls. The next time the customer had a question, he discovered that his new best friend the RM was not interested in listening to him. This story may not describe every insurance sale in India. It does, however, describe the question now hanging over the industry: "Are we selling insurance because people need protection. Or because somebody needs to sell a product?"

Insurance is unlike most financial products. A customer can buy a policy today and discover its real value years later, perhaps when illness strikes, an accident occurs or a family loses its principal earner. But the person selling it, our friend the RM, has been rewarded on the day the policy was sold.

That is where the trouble begins.

Follow the Money

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has now proposed a significant overhaul of the economics of insurance distribution. Its September consultation paper has proposed product- and channel-specific limits on commissions, tighter overall expense limits for insurers and a restructuring of how distributors are rewarded.

For several products, first-year commissions would be vastly lower than levels currently prevailing. For instance, in individual health insurance, the proposal puts first-year commissions at 15 per cent for distribution entities and 20 per cent for agents, with lower renewal commissions. For longer-term life policies, the proposed first-year limits are also lower than existing commissions, while remuneration would be spread across the policy term. The regulator has also proposed safeguards against the compulsory bundling of insurance with loans and credit.

That last part is very interesting. Walk into a bank for a loan and the customer may naturally expect to discuss the loan. But nearly unseen, insurance may enter the conversation, because the economics of selling it can be attractive. That creates an itchy outcome: An RM may begin seeing a customer not as a person seeking financial advice, but as a potential source of insurance revenue. And commissions.

This does not mean every banker is doing it. Nor does it mean every insurance policy sold through a bank is unsuitable. It just means that incentives matter. A lot. If a product pays far more for being sold today than for being properly serviced over the years, the system can encourage selling. And once selling becomes the priority, advice can become secondary.

The IRDAI's proposed reforms are, in part, an attempt to correct that imbalance.



ONCE SELLING BECOMES THE PRIORITY AND THE COMMISSIONS THAT ACCRUE FROM IT GET HANDSOME, OFFERING SIMPLE FINANCIAL ADVICE CAN BECOME SECONDARY

CUSTOMER PAYS TWICE

There is another irony. High distribution costs can raise the economics of selling a policy. But reducing commissions does not mean the customer will receive a cheaper or better product.

The industry has a legitimate argument. Agents do real work. They acquire customers, explain complex products, service policies and remain the bridge between insurers and customers, who may otherwise have little understanding of insurance. The industry, thus, has argued that reductions in commissions could weaken distribution, particularly in small towns and rural areas where personal selling remains important. Insurers and intermediaries have also sought a phased implementation of the proposed changes. That argument deserves to be heard. For India cannot solve its insurance problem by making it unattractive to sell insurance. The country needs more insurance, not less.

The Government's own data shows why. India's overall insurance penetration was 3.7 per cent in 2024-25, with life insurance at 2.7 per cent and non-life at 1 per cent. Insurance density rose to $97 (Rs 9,346). The challenge, therefore, is not merely to reduce the commission bill. It is to change the way



the industry rewards.

If a salesman earns for bringing in a customer, some part of that reward should depend on the policy remaining active, being properly serviced and the customer continuing to find value in it. If an agent disappears after the first premium, the system has rewarded acquisition, while neglecting ownership.

That is not merely a commission problem. It is a design problem.

When Silence Comes

The caveat with insurance is that the customer discovers the quality of the sale only much later. Other financial instruments are different. A mutual fund statement arrives. A fixed deposit matures. A stock can be sold. But insurance is different. The customer buys a promise. And promises, by definition, are tested only when something goes wrong.

That is particularly so in health insurance. A family can spend years paying premiums without making a claim. Then comes a hospital admission, after an accident or a sudden illness. The family is no longer sitting across a desk discussing tax deductions and future returns. It is sitting outside a hospital room. That is when exclusions, waiting periods, sub-limits, documentation and definitions suddenly acquire a very different meaning.

IRDAI's data show that general and health insurers together received 137,361 grievances in FY 2024-25. The figure was 41 per cent higher than the previous year, with claims-related issues forming a major part of the complaints. By itself, the existence of complaints does not mean insurers routinely reject legitimate claims. Nor should every disputed claim be treated as evidence of wrongdoing.

But the sheer importance of the claims process is impossible to ignore. Insurance is ultimately judged at the hospital accounts department, not the sales counter. That is where the industry's trust problem becomes a deciding factor.

The Foreign Investor

Welcome to the investor dichotomy. India has spent years trying to make its insurance market more attractive. In February 2025, the Government announced that the foreign direct investment limit in insurance would rise from 74 per cent to 100 per cent. Parliament passed the *'Sabka Bima, Sabki Raksha'* legislation, saying the move would attract capital, technology and global best practices.

That is a significant opening of the door. But investors do not enter a market because the door is open. They also look at the economics inside the room. IRDAI's commission reforms have raised concerns among insurers, intermediaries and investors, and the impact they foresee has prompted concern. Enough concern to make them dissect the economics of distribution, acquisition and servicing.

The dissection is not the problem. The issue is whether India can create an insurance market in which profitability and policyholder value reinforce each other, not pull in opposite directions.

What of the Policy?

It is good that the Government opened up the insurance sector. Competition improves products. Capital brings technology. Foreign participation brings global practices. But none can substitute for something much simpler: Trust. That is why the authorities moved in 2025 to protect the policyholder.

But regulation cannot do everything. Insurers must decide whether distributors are rewarded for selling policies or building relationships. Banks must decide whether their RMs are financial advisers first or salesmen first. And customers, too, must learn to ask harder questions before signing.

The industry, meanwhile, has to accept a rather inconvenient truth: the insurance business does not end when the policy is sold. That is when the real relationship begins.

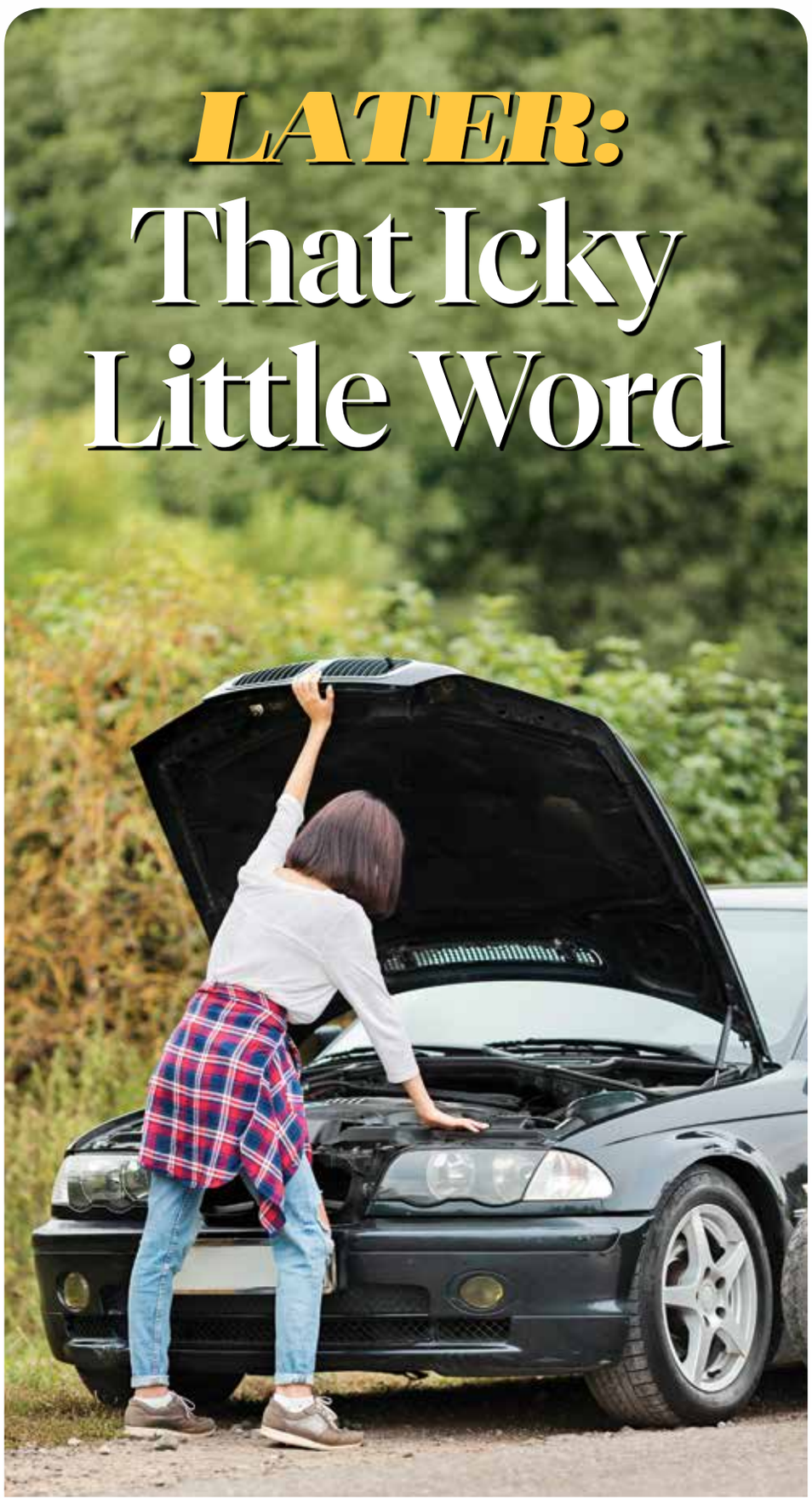
Because someday, the customer will need to know whether he bought insurance, or just a document that looked like protection. And that is what the industry must remember. Why did the customer buy the policy in the first place? He did not buy a sales pitch. He did not buy a commission. He did not buy a bank's financial target. He bought protection. Against the odds.

1
SMALL WARNING

2
TIMES IGNORED

10x
BIGGER BILL

LATER: That Icky Little Word



AUTHOR

RAJEEV NARAYAN

Sometimes, 'later' means tomorrow. The tomorrow that never comes. And in a car, it can mean discovering the crisis only after the damage is truly done

There are few words more useful in everyday life than 'later'. I will send her the flowers later. I will get that medical test done later. I will see the dentist later; it only hurts occasionally. I will tell the boss I am quitting later. I will have that difficult conversation with her later.

And then there is the car. A tyre looks a little soft. Later. There is a faint noise when you brake. Later. The steering wheel has developed a tiny vibration. Later. The service reminder has been staring at you for three weeks. Later.

Nothing is dangerously wrong. Yet. That last word is where trouble begins. Because the car does not understand procrastination. It understands wear, friction, pressure, heat and mileage. Ignore those things long enough and the car eventually translates 'later' into a language everybody understands. Bill. Big bill.

Just a Little

Cars rarely begin demanding money suddenly. Usually, they start with something small enough to ignore. The engine sounds slightly different. Later. The brakes feel a little less sharp. Later. The suspension makes a dull thunk over a pothole. Later. The air-conditioner is blowing, but with all the enthusiasm of a tired ceiling fan. Later. The wipers leave a perfect stripe across the windscreen. Later.

And that little warning light on the dashboard? Surely it can wait until the weekend. The weekend comes. Then another one. The car continues to move. So, technically, everything is fine.

This is the great advantage of owning a car. And the great disadvantage. A car can continue moving while quietly collecting problems. We are particularly good at postponing the boring things. Nobody wants to spend a Saturday morning at the workshop because the air filter needs changing. Nobody gets excited about wheel alignment. Nobody calls a friend to announce that they have finally replaced the brake pads.

But these are precisely the things that keep a car from becoming a story.

The tyre that has been losing pressure slowly? Check it. The steering that no longer feels quite straight? Get the alignment done. The brakes making that faint scraping sound? Have them inspected. The battery taking a little longer to wake up every morning? Do not wait for the morning when it doesn't. The oil has done its kilometres? Change it. The service is due? Service it.

There is nothing glamorous about any of this. Which is probably why we postpone it.

Nothing Serious

We spend hours comparing mobile phones before buying one, then spend 15 minutes choosing tyres for a car that may carry our entire family down a wet highway. Then we wonder why the car does not feel right.

Tyres are particularly good at exposing this attitude. A little uneven wear? Later. Tread getting low? There is still some left. Pressure dropping every few weeks? Just fill it again. Until the day the tyre decides it has had enough. And tyres are only one part of the equation.

A neglected air filter can affect how an engine breathes. A worn brake pad does not become safer because we have ignored it for another month. Wheel alignment does not improve because the steering wheel has been sitting at an angle for six weeks.

And that strange noise from underneath? That is perhaps the most efficiently ignored object in motoring. If the car makes a noise once, we listen. If it makes the same noise every day, we stop hearing it. Somewhere between the first clunk and the tenth, the sound becomes part of the car's personality.

We even give it names. "That's always been there." Usually, it hasn't.

Some relationships are like worn-out tyres. You know they need changing. You keep telling yourself there is still some tread left. And sometimes, of course, there is always the argument for "just one more time". But let us stay with the car.

Pay Now, Or Later

The strange thing about preventive maintenance is that when it works, nothing happens. You replace the brake pads before they damage the discs. Nothing happens. You change the tyre before the tread disappears. Nothing happens. You replace the battery before it dies outside the office on a Monday evening. Nothing happens. You fix the suspension noise before a small problem becomes a larger one. Nothing happens.

And because nothing happens, we wonder whether we really needed to spend the money. That is the peculiar economics of maintaining a car. You pay to prevent an event that you will never see.

Nobody congratulates you for replacing a worn tyre before it fails. Nobody notices that your brake pads were changed before metal began grinding against metal. There is no trophy for avoiding a breakdown. Just a car that starts every morning.

And perhaps that is the whole point. The best-maintained car is often the least interesting car in the world. It starts. It runs. It turns. It stops. It cools.

Until It Hurts

But 'later' has another quality. It tends to become more expensive with age. The tyre wasn't particularly expensive. The damaged wheel was. The brake pads weren't particularly expensive. The discs were. The service wasn't particularly expensive. The roadside breakdown was. The little suspension noise wasn't frightening. The repair bill that followed certainly was.

The car has not betrayed you. You betrayed the car. You ignored the calendar. Perhaps that is why cars are such good teachers of the word 'later'. They do not argue with us. They simply keep giving us hints. So the next time the dashboard lights up, the tyre looks a little soft, the brakes sound different, the steering feels strange, or the car tells you it is time for a service, don't say later.

The car has no idea what later means. Neither does the mechanic. And certainly not the bill. Later has a curious habit of arriving with a tow truck.

IN LIFE, WE POSTPONE LITTLE THINGS BECAUSE NOTHING HAS HAPPENED YET. BUT IN CARS, THE 'TOMORROW' ITCH CAN MAKE US PAY STEEPLY FOR OUR INANE BRAVADO



Wellness

When every feeling gets labelled



Mental health vocabulary has spread widely online, but greater familiarity has not always brought greater understanding

AUTHOR

ERA DUTTA

Mental health slop is an informal term for the flood of low-quality, oversimplified mental health content online that sounds therapeutic or psychologically insightful but lacks nuance, evidence or clinical accuracy.

Examples include:

» "If they wanted to, they would."
» "Your anxiety is just your intuition."
» "Everyone who hurts you is a narcissist."
» "Cut off anyone who drains your energy."
» "You are not lazy, you are traumatised."
» Labelling ordinary relationship conflict as "gaslighting" or "toxic."

The problem is not that these statements are always completely false. It is that they turn complex psychological phenomena into catchy, absolute explanations designed for engagement rather than understanding.

Mental health slop is content that borrows therapeutic and diagnostic terms but presents them as oversimplified, absolute, emotionally satisfying claims, often with little evidence behind them. This isn't about social media versus professionals. Good mental health education exists online. The problem is complexity getting sacrificed for virality.

Why is it more viral?

It spreads easily because it offers explanations for confusing experiences. Algorithms reward recognition – the "this is SO me" reaction – and nuance rarely survives a 15-second reel.

» "Narcissist" is easier than understanding personality traits.
» "Trauma" is easier than sitting with years of complicated experience.
» "Attachment style" is easier than examining one specific relationship.

What is the downside?

The result is the pathologising of ordinary life.

Sadness becomes depression, tiredness becomes burnout, wanting your partner's reassurance becomes anxious attachment, selfishness becomes narcissism, every disagreement becomes gaslighting and a hard childhood becomes trauma. Not every difficult experience is a disorder, and not every unpleasant relationship needs a psychiatric explanation.

People now diagnose themselves, partners, parents and colleagues from a list of reels and carousels. But psychiatric diagnosis requires context, duration, severity, functional impairment and differential assessment. Recognising yourself in six slides is not the same as having a disorder.

What are the grave repercussions?

Here's the deeper cost. Trauma, narcissism, attachment, boundaries, dissociation and gaslighting are legitimate concepts. The problem is conceptual inflation. When every uncomfortable interaction becomes "gaslighting," the word stops helping anyone identify actual gaslighting.

The consequences are real: misdiagnosis, unnecessary fear, relationship breakdown, avoidance of responsibility, overidentification with illness, delayed professional assessment and false certainty about other people's motives. A strange paradox follows.

People become fluent in mental health vocabulary without becoming better at understanding mental health.

Mental health slop rarely spreads outright misinformation. That would be easier to counter. It spreads half-truths stripped of context, and half-truths are often more persuasive than obvious nonsense because they contain just enough that's real.

SOCIAL MEDIA VIRALITY CAN FLATTEN COMPLEX PSYCHOLOGICAL CONCEPTS INTO ABSOLUTES

The real question should be: What does good mental health content look like?

A useful distinction: Mental health education: "Here are several possible reasons someone may struggle with boundaries." Mental health slop: "If you struggle with boundaries, you have childhood trauma."

Good mental health content acknowledges uncertainty while distinguishing symptoms from diagnoses, gives context and doesn't diagnose strangers. It cites credible evidence and recognises that the same behaviour can have several explanations. It tells you when it's time to see a professional instead of another viral reel.

Perhaps the opposite of stigma isn't calling everything a mental health problem. Perhaps it's becoming comfortable with psychological complexity, sitting with "it depends" instead of reaching for the nearest label.

Do you find yourself hooked on mental health slop too? Time to be a little more aware.

Women of the Hills



The anthology Women Writers of Uttarakhand celebrates 60 women whose diverse literary voices have enriched India's cultural and literary landscape

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

Four years ago, Dr Jaiwanti Dimri typed "Women writers from Uttarakhand writing in English" on Google. Her initial search led to a modest list of eleven authors. Eventually, as she kept following threads of conversation and investigation, the list grew to an astonishing sixty – with pages left for more in the next anthology, hopefully: "Sixty women writers of Uttarakhand origin by birth, ancestry or stay in the hill state of Uttarakhand writing across genres who have enriched the literary and cultural landscape of not only Uttarakhand but have registered their presence on the national and global platform."

Beginning with an introduction about historical and literary contexts, this anthology of the "author daughters of Uttarakhand" (as described by the inimitable Himalayan scholar Shekhar Pathak) aims to illuminate the female legacies of writers from the Devbhoomi. The effort is aligned with a larger desire to decolonise our understanding of world literature through a focus on Indian literature from these mountains which have stood guard on the subcontinent for 50 million years.

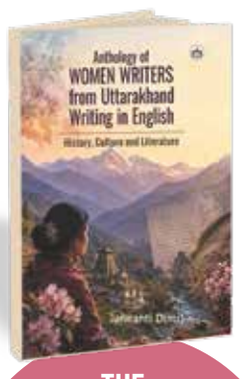
There are acclaimed English-language writers like Anita Desai (born in Mussoorie), Nayantara Sahgal (based in Dehradun), Anuradha Roy (based in Ranikhet), Tavleen Singh (born in Mussoorie) and Vandana Shiva (born in Dehradun). There are also women who translate from within and outside of Uttarakhand: Usha Naudiyal, Smita Karnatak, Madhu D. Singh, Madhu Joshi, Madhu Mehrotra, Deepa Agarwal, Surekha Dangwal. Women who extend the spiritual traditions of the Devbhoomi are featured as well, including Bettina Bäumer, Maria Wirth, and Sadhvi Bhagwati Saraswati.

The book pays tribute to the late Colleen Gantzer (1934-2024), born in Gujarat but much beloved in Mussoorie, who was posthumously awarded the Padma Shri for her invaluable contribution to travel literature in the country. Her writings with her husband, retired naval commander Hugh Gantzer, include the series Intriguing India: Colourful East / Vibrant West / Historic South / Alluring North published by Niyogi Books between 2011 and 2013.

Readers and residents of Uttarakhand will be familiar with the pleasure of the years when one would read Gantzer's occasional columns in local publications. They may also recall Dr Jaskiran Chopra, whose poetry has been known to most everyone who has visited the Valley of Words over the years. She took a keen interest in Dehradun's cultural development, and her deep love for this capital city was reflected in her collection of Urdu poems in "Mera Sheher".

Another Dehradun-based columnist is the prolific Ratna Manucha, who published Unfiltered: The Little Things, about life's irrepressible daily tribulations and joys, about a year ago. This very week, she has released another book titled From My Bookshelf, which contains an edited selection of book reviews by Dr Sanjeev Chopra. There is also Dr Tania Saili Bakshi, whose work is well-known not only to readers across the state and beyond, but is also deeply appreciated by those Uttarakhandi artists and entrepreneurs whom she has consistently platformed through her journalism over the years. Most readers in Dehradun will likely know of Anjali Nauriyal too – her book Retelling the Story of Traditional Ballads of Garhwal preserves the rich cultural memories of folk songs for future generations.

There are profiles of remarkable historical authors like the crime fiction writer Patricia Wentworth,



THE ANTHOLOGY CONNECTS CELEBRATED AUTHORS WITH VOICES WHOSE HISTORIES DESERVE GREATER RECOGNITION

the Gandhian activist Sarla Behn, and social reformer Tara Ali Baig. The long arc of the book accelerates to cover tectonic shifts in time to contemporary authors like bureaucrat Ekta Uniyal (The Mountain Girl) along with Sunita Pant Bansal and Kiran Manral. Also included are profiles of screenwriter Advaita Kala, who published the novel Almost Single and the film Anjaana Anjaani, among others, alongside the poetry of the brilliant Urvashi Bahuguna who writes from around the world: "A woman in the distance / waves. Who, me? I step away from the cliffs. / Two girls ask if I will photograph them & I ask / back: in the photo, I look small & full of wonder. / A pinecone tightly wound into itself."

The pages on Nergis Dalal are followed by biographical detail about the writings of her daughter, Dr Roshen Dalal, who has authored several popular books on spirituality for children. Ira Pande has written about her mother, the acclaimed author Gaura Pant "Shivani" (Diddi: My Mother's Voice; 2005) and so has her sister Mrinal (Daughter's Daughter; 1993).

In an interview, the unmatched author Namita Gokhale made a statement which perhaps braids together the many diverse lives which are profiled in this anthology: "My way of looking at the world remains trapped in that primary identity: once you start loving the hills they hold on to you". Similarly, there is a quote from Bachendri Pal, the first woman to scale Mount Everest, from her self-narrative: "We, the hill people, have always worshipped the mountains. My overpowering emotion at this awe-inspiring spectacle was, therefore, devotional."

There are many legacies which are still missing. Women like Gaura Devi, who raised a movement of ecofeminism without due credit, have still not been written about adequately and far too little survives of their own voices. Yet it can also be said that their focus on "Jal Jangal Jameen" needs no inscription in print to animate our resonating need for harmony with nature. Anandamayi Ma did not write either, but conveyed meaning beyond words and established ashrams in Dehradun and Haridwar which continue to pulsate with the quiet beauty which characterised her mystic life. There are several other women whose histories have to be reclaimed – Teelu Rauteli, Jasuli Amma, Tincheri Mai, Chandraprabha Aitwal – and women whose histories are yet to be written – the mountaineer sisters Tashi and Nungshi Malik, for example.

"Loving and zealously guarding one's space is a virtue, not a disqualification by any account," writes Dr Dimri. There have been other women writers with unexpected connections to these hills – Qurratulain Hyder writes about Mussoorie with a vividness that is impossible to replicate – and there are many whose names add to Google's inventory of Uttarakhandi women writers today: Shivya Nath, Bijoya Sawian, Madhu Gurung, Niraja Gopal Jayal, Mohini Gupta, Anju Rana, Pooja Marwah, Neha Mittal, Sunita Vijay, Kusum Ansal, Pratibha Katiyar... May these verdant valleys and hills keep uplifting writers – writing in English or Garhwali or Kumaoni or Jaunsari or Pahari or Nepali or Dogri or Hindi or any other variant of the many expressions gathering across the vast range of our beloved Himalayas.

PART V

Reading the Climate Signals

Research had revealed how local interactions between aerosols, clouds and oceans complicated predictions of the pace of global warming

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

In the last article, we looked at how Earth's albedo was falling and its interplay with the rising heat uptake by the oceans, as well as the rising acidity of the oceans. In this part, we will discuss the work of various scientists in this regard.

Forcings versus feedbacks

This leads us to an important debate in climate science: that of 'forcings versus feedbacks'. 'Forcings' are simply anthropogenic activities, such as massive injections of carbon dioxide into the atmosphere or a rise in sulphur dioxide because of industrial emissions, which disturb the energy balance of the Earth. 'Feedbacks' are the reactions to these forcings, such as the melting of ice and warming of the oceans.

The connection between 'forcings' and 'feedbacks' has been revised by the research of various scientists, such as Bjorn Stevens and Piers Forster, Norman Loeb, Gunnar Myhre, Hodnebrog, Armour and Rugenstein.

Stevens versus Hansen

Stevens and Forster found that aerosols trigger an impact on clouds almost immediately, even before any global warming has occurred,



and called it rapid adjustment or a non-linear impact. Stevens also found that the 'cooling' effect of aerosols was much less than that assumed in many climate models. This would mean that the 'warming effect' of greenhouse gases would also be much lower, implying that global warming is not as rapid as many think and can be managed. On the other hand, James Hansen, using palaeoclimatic data and observations following International Maritime Organization regulations – where stricter regulations on sulphur emissions by shipping lines were followed by an immediate rise in temperatures in the North Atlantic – has suggested the opposite: that the 'unmasking effect' of aerosols is actually huge and will lead to accelerated global warming.

Loeb, Myhre and Hodnebrog

Norman Loeb, the scientist leading NASA's CERES project, has been collecting data on the Earth's albedo for the past 25 years. Myhre and Hodnebrog are Norwegian scientists who have carried out chemical modelling of aerosols and, based on primary data, have analysed how different types of aerosols interact with clouds. In an article published in Science in June 2025, Myhre, Hodnebrog, Loeb and Forster argue that the findings of low-climate-sensitivity models – those that assume lower warming as a result of greenhouse gas emissions – are contradictory to the data collected by CERES. In other words, future warming is likely to be higher and stronger than low-climate-sensitivity models suggest, and urgent action is therefore needed.

Further, they argue that the forcings of greenhouse gases are global in nature, while those of aerosols are local and limited to the mid-latitudes of the Northern Hemisphere – North America, Europe and Asia. As a result, the interaction is with the local atmosphere, which changes the cloud cover. They concluded that an energy imbalance caused by aerosols will require a higher surface temperature change compared with such an imbalance caused by greenhouse gases.

CLOUDS AND AEROSOLS REMAIN AMONG THE MOST DIFFICULT VARIABLES IN CLIMATE MODELLING

Interestingly, David Stainforth has commended this research by the Oslo group and used it to underline his policy prescription: if climate feedbacks are based on local geography, then past data often used in Global Climate Models cannot be used to predict the local climate. Hence, there is a need to focus more on localised issues rather than refining such global climate models to produce more precise probabilities.

Understanding pattern effects

Armour and Rugenstein echo the findings of Myhre, Hodnebrog et al. when they say that the effects of climate feedback are a local phenomenon. Rugenstein, using thousands of years of climate data, says that these feedbacks change over centuries and that short-term observations will lead to faulty estimations of long-run climate feedbacks. Armour and Rugenstein say that climate feedback loops and their strength, speed and direction depend on the geographical pattern of surface warming across the oceans.

They give the example of the East Pacific, which is naturally cooler and has sinking air and low stratocumulus clouds, and the West Pacific, which is naturally warm and has sinking air, water-laden clouds and rainfall. They say that if the East Pacific also warms up because of global warming, the temperature differential with the West Pacific will fall and air circulation will slow. This will cause the bright and reflective marine clouds over the East Pacific to dissolve, leading to a lower albedo and the ocean absorbing more heat, thus accelerating global warming. The opposite will result if the West Pacific warms more than usual.

Interpreting climate models

In earlier articles in this Climate Series, we saw the challenges faced in constructing climate models and the even greater difficulties in interpreting the results of climate model simulations. Specifically, we may recall that the modelling of local phenomena, such as clouds and aerosols, poses a challenge. In this two-part article, we looked at CERES data and other experiments, such as Argo floats. In the second part, we examined the work of scientists in interpreting the impact of clouds and aerosols on the Earth's albedo. Their work will help us interpret the output of climate models better.

FROM HOCKEY AND ARCHERY TO BOXING, WRESTLING AND GOLF, AND NOW CRICKET, INDIA'S ATHLETES HAD OVERCOME ADVERSITY TO DELIVER MEMORABLE PERFORMANCES IN NAGOYA

NEW CHAMPIONS, Bigger EXPECTATIONS



Players pose for photographs after winning gold medal in the women's final Hockey match

Neeru Dhanda

Kumkum Mohod

Vithya Ramraj

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Congratulations and celebrations. Well done, Indian athletes; you have shown courage, grit and tenacity. To do well in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, at the Asian Games is a tribute to your skills, inner will and strong mind control. Before anyone jumps upon reading these first few lines, do not talk of the medal tally before the Hangzhou, China, Asian Games in 2023.

Sample the variety of medals India has won in Nagoya, a pathetic port city in a First World country. Sitting in the comfort of a drawing room and watching the action unfold on television in India, one does not get a clear picture of how hard it was there. Every imaginable kind of problem was there in the host city, debunking the belief that Japan could put on a show where economy as hosts meant compromising big time with the delivery of the Games.

To each Indian athlete who has won a medal at the Asian Games in Nagoya, with women ruling the roost, you faced immense hardships. First, the star parade of medal winners for India, where the girls showed mettle. The transport facilities were a nightmare, and scheduling in badminton was chaos, which PV Sindhu has talked of.

I will narrate my own story of how the Organising Committee in Nagoya messed up my media accreditation card. Today is the closing ceremony, and my media badge for *Millennium Post* is yet to come. Efforts to get a visa for Japan were also futile, so much for the help from the Embassy in New Delhi.

Flummoxed and left with no other options, I had to watch all the action on TV and cell phone handsets and track scores/results on the website. The shooting venue at the Asian Games was a stinking place, far away from the city. Such has been the nightmare for shooters, officials, coaches and the media who dared to go to Nagoya; the hassles were unlimited. Five hours of total travel time, up and down, was crazy. There were instances when the official bus packed up or met with an accident.

On Friday, the women's hockey final started an hour late as a road accident delayed traffic flow. Can you believe it? If such a thing had happened in New Delhi, the global media would have erupted!

Never mind, congratulations to the hockey girls for producing that golden glow, finally, after 44 years. Pluck and poise, with coach Sjoerd Marijne showing, again, he could optimise performance from the 'Bharat Ki Shernis', India won gold. It was a team effort for sure, though special credit for goalkeeper Savita Punia is in place. From here to the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028, it's going to be a joy as preparations can be planned well, with automatic qualification achieved. What needs to be done urgently is that Hockey India's dirty politics has to end. An official like Bholanath Singh, the secretary, must be thrown out. He faces serious charges of 'harassment' and is under probe. Add to it a director general who has bungled; Hockey India needs good people at the helm with President Dilip Tirkey.

How does one capture the fortnight-long highs, even though the gold medal tally was less compared to Hangzhou? For sure, the variety of medals won this time was brilliant. Imagine, a young archer, just 17, was on fire. Kumkum Anil Mohod winning a gold in the recurve event was path-breaking. Not only the medal, but to book a berth for the LA Olympics is great.

My good friend, Virendra Sachdeva, who is the Secretary General of the Archery Association of India, has been working tirelessly. For those who say 'netas' should not be office-bearers in national sports federations, Sachdeva has worked really hard for decades. Archery is his passion, and how the boys and girls peaked this time is a great story. To mention each name would be in order, but for the sheer burst of brilliance, the 17-year-old Kumkum from Amravati, Maharashtra, has been sensational. How she stayed calm is a lesson in how, today, India's young athletes are fearless on the big stage.

If one mentions the names of Chikitha Taniparthi, Jyothi Surekha Vennam and more, they have also been consistent in hitting the bull's-eye with the bow and arrow. How does one not mention the name of Dhiraj Bommadevara, a true Arjuna with bow and arrow? Overall, five gold, two silver and two bronze medals won in archery in Nagoya need to be celebrated.

Move to the golfing greens, and Pranavi Sharath Urs, 23, from Mysuru, smashed the field. A well-known pro, how she won gold on Saturday is a delight. She had a triple bogey in the final round on the last day and then came back. To rub shoulders with World No. 6 Ruoning Yin and get the better of her will be talked of for a long time. How Pranavi peaked and also featured in a team medal with Aditi Ashok and Diksha Dagar is a good story. After all, Aditi and Diksha have been around for so long.

If one mentions boxing, the weight of punches inside the ring was heavy. Lovlina Borgohain, the quiet girl from Assam, channelising her inner energy, is fascinating. Lovlina is a quiet, simple girl. Having moved to the higher weight category of 75kg, the cherubic lass has strived hard for perfection. At the Glasgow Commonwealth Games, Lovlina was off-colour. She had told this writer in July that her aim would be to do well in the Asian Games.

What a way she has landed gold, all with authority. Just to remind readers, in Glasgow, Lovlina had been smart in flagging to an Indian restaurant how a distorted India map hurt her. She spoke about it and earned praise, even from Prime Minister Narendra Modi. After all, the North East states in India are very special. Yes, Lovlina wears patriotism on her shoulders. On a day Lovlina was celebrating her 29th birthday, this gold medal should serve as a booster for the next Olympic cycle. Add the medals of Parveen Hooda and Ankush Pangal in boxing, and the campaign has been one of intensity at the Asian Games.

A bit of context: there has been some negativity surrounding the Boxing Federation of India since 2025. President Ajay Singh and his team are firm; they will take on even Sarkari Babus. Perhaps, the time has come when the independence of national sports federations needs to be respected.

In wrestling, the gold medal won by Sujeet Kalkal is defining. Competing in the 65kg weight category, Sujeet was ready to wrestle with josh. Later, in media interactions, he spoke of how positivity in the sport, again, is important. Since the time street protests broke out at New Delhi's Jantar Mantar in 2023, wrestling has been under a cloud. It is pertinent to mention that people got carried away by recalcitrant Vinesh Phogat and Bajrang Punia. In that period, many genuine wrestlers suffered. Sujeet has spoken about it well.

Nitesh Siwach is another path-breaker. India does not have a great tradition where Greco-Roman wrestlers have won important medals. Nitesh won gold in the 97kg weight section, which is big. The last medal in this event came for India at the 1962 Asian Games in Jakarta.

How India fared in track and field, minus superstar Neeraj Chopra, is important. Neeraj was absent due to an ankle injury, but for two more javelin exponents, Yashvir Singh and Neeraj Yadav, to win silver and bronze is a sign of future stars already being there. Surely, Neeraj has shown the way in javelin.

Overall, India won 24 medals – one gold, nine silver and 14 bronze – from the athletics arena. Indeed, the name of Vithya Ramraj, the 400m runner, is now well-known. To feature in two relays and the 400m hurdles and break PT Usha's old record, dating back to the 1984 Olympics in Los Angeles, has made people sit up. Daughter of a truck driver, Vithya dreams big. She wants to go below 54 seconds in the 400m hurdles. Can she improve? Can she go for glory at the LA Olympics? We will watch, and so will PT Usha.

If Vithya was all smiles, quiet Gulveer Singh went about his task of winning three medals in Nagoya with calmness. The Armyman is quiet and does not speak much. How much he has gained by training abroad in Colorado Springs, USA, has become evident. To win two medals at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games and bounce back in Nagoya, he defines consistency.

India may be less than happy with the performances in shooting. But then, despite the fewer medals won, Neeru Dhanda showed a large heart and appetite. Mentored by Mansher Singh, a seasoned pro, Neeru won a historic gold medal in trap shooting for women, a first, and then garnered two more medals. Hailing from Haryana, how Neeru fought a bad bout of flu in New Delhi, flew out and surged ahead is now part of folklore. Watch out for her at the closing ceremony tonight, as she will be the flag-bearer. Indian shooting does need to reflect on why it did badly in pistol and rifle events. Some of the coaches are repeat failures and must be educated.

Can India feel happy or look at where medals were lost? Definitely, there is scope for improvement. Tennis, badminton and a few more disciplines did not do well. And why the Indian Government sent so many fencing athletes is the butt of ridicule. It is important that the policymakers in Indian sports are objective. As it were, national sports federations are made to feel redundant. The control freaks must pause and ponder.

To top the golden campaign, India's men won the gold medal in cricket. To punch the tricky Pakistanis, again, in the T20 format is satisfying! It is also a reminder that hype over India versus Pakistan is a thing of the past. And the best part: Mohsin Naqvi, President of the Asian Cricket Council, was asked to stay away. No handshake between India and Pakistan; treat it as the new normal.



Pranavi Urs

INDIA'S MEDALS ACROSS DIVERSE DISCIPLINES UNDERLINED THE GROWING DEPTH, VERSATILITY AND PROMISE OF ITS ATHLETES

'ALL GREAT THINGS IN LIFE ARE ALWAYS HARD'

Tahir Raj Bhasin wants to be 'remembered' for his varied performances, not just be 'famous'

Bollywood actor Tahir Raj Bhasin said he wants to be remembered through his work rather than merely being famous, a philosophy that has influenced his choice of roles across genres.

The actor made his debut in 2012 with 'Kismat Love Paisa Dilli', starring Vivek Oberoi and Malika Sherawat, followed by a brief appearance in Sushant Singh Rajput's 'Kai Po Che!' and 'One by Two' alongside Abhay Deol.

He had his breakout performance with Rani Mukerji-fronted 'Mardaani', in which he played the antagonist.



EARLY IN HIS CAREER, HE REALISED THE IMPORTANCE OF DIVERSIFYING HIS FILMOGRAPHY TO AVOID THE INDUSTRY'S TENDENCY

"I believe all great things in life are always hard. There is a favourite saying on acting that I love to live by, which is, 'There is a difference between being famous and being remembered' and I choose the latter. I make all of my choices based on that," Bhasin told PTI in an interview.

He added, "I want to be remembered as an actor who led gripping stories and made people aware of the experience of being human and the many emotions like thrill, emotion, etc."

Bhasin said early in his career, he realised the importance of diversifying his filmography to avoid the industry's tendency to stereotype actors in particular roles.

"It was challenging at the start because when you debut with an anti-heroish part like in 'Mardaani', then people want to see you in the same thing, which I also took as a compliment. But then it takes a little bit of conscious self-awareness where you want to take a step back and say that if I keep doing five of this, it will be difficult to break out of that," said Bhasin, who went on to play an antagonist in John Abraham-starrer 'Force 2'.

The actor said films such as Nandita Das's 'Manto', in which he played yesteryear Bollywood superstar and Manto's close friend Shyam Chadda and Nitesh Tiwari-directed coming-of-age comedy drama 'Chhichhore' are apt examples of his effort to play diverse characters.

"In 'Manto', I had the opportunity to work with Nawazuddin Siddiqui, which was amazing. We were shooting in the villages of Gujarat and the next thing we were walking the red carpet in Cannes; it was incredible exposure. Then I did a more commercial action film like 'Force 2' with John Abraham and 'Chhichhore' with Nitesh Tiwari. These are all intentional choices where you get to different genres, different kinds of directors," he shared.

The actor said he feels 'fortunate' to be getting the opportunity to do both feature films and web series at the same time.

Bhasin further added that his latest 'Netflix' series 'Shaque', directed by Rensil D'Silva, challenged him to explore a different understanding of masculinity.

Headlined by Parineeti Chopra, the series follows Anvita, a mother whose newborn daughter is abducted from a hospital.

Nine years later, she remains determined to find her child, with mysterious photographs of the girl arriving on her birthday each year. As Anvita pursues new leads, she begins to question the people closest to her, blurring the line between truth, suspicion and obsession, according to the official synopsis.

Bhasin plays Parineeti Chopra's husband in the show, which made its debut on 'Netflix' recently.

"The challenge in 'Shaque' was to display the masculinity that we don't often see in our cinemas. Like, being with a vulnerable female protagonist, being an emotional support in a family, being a husband but also being a son, a father and a friend and going through a traumatic experience but also facing the consequences of one's own choices," he said. PTI



Got a politician father, will become cricket administrator



For generations, for Indian politicians, the easiest way of settling their children in life was to get them into politics

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

RAJASTHAN'S LATEST RCA CONTEST SUGGESTS THAT THE CRICKET PITCH IS BECOMING INCREASINGLY CROWDED WITH POLITICAL HEIRS

When Vaibhav Gehlot, son of Ashok Gehlot, the then chief minister, was elected president of the Rajasthan Cricket Association, a giant hoarding on behalf of Rajasthan Berozgar Ekikrit Mahasangh appeared at Jaipur's Sawai Mansingh Stadium entrance gate, congratulating Vaibhav on getting a new job!

The irony and satire in the hoarding could have easily beaten the daily witty 'Amul' ads. A body of unemployed youth was happy that at least one of them now has a job!

Vaibhav's case was not the exception; it's the continuation of a trend which has come into vogue in the last few decades for politicians to settle their children.

Vaibhav was first elected RCA president in October 2019 and re-elected in December 2022, when his father was chief minister of Rajasthan. He resigned on February 26, 2024, after the BJP came to power in the state. This sequence runs according to the power equation - father becomes chief minister, son becomes cricket president; father loses office, son is out of power.

As far as Rajasthan is concerned, Gehlot is no longer an isolated case. Five politicians from the ruling BJP, including two ministers, now have their children in the fray for positions in the upcoming Rajasthan Cricket Association election. In other words, a new generation of political heirs appears to be following in the footsteps of Gehlot.

For generations, for Indian politicians, the easiest way of settling their children in life was to get them into politics, banking on their family name and the loyalty of the constituency. For those not having an inclination for politics, setting up a business was the other option.

Now cricket administration has become the third and most lucrative option. Whether the aspiring cricket administrator has ever wielded a cricket bat is not important.

In today's India, if your father is a politician, he can get you or create a job for you, which Lester Burnham wanted in American Beauty: "I'm looking for a job with the least amount of responsibility." The phenomenon is hardly confined to one political party or one family. Indian cricket administration has for decades attracted politicians and their relatives.

Anurag Thakur, son of former Himachal Pradesh chief minister Prem Kumar Dhumal, rose through the Himachal Pradesh Cricket Association and eventually became BCCI president. His brother Arun Dhumal later headed the HPCA and went on to the IPL Governing Council. The Dalmiya family turned cricket administration into a family tradition, with Jagmohan Dalmiya followed by his son Avishek in the Cricket Association of Bengal. The Scindias have had a similarly long association with cricket administration in Madhya Pradesh.

And then there is Jay Shah, son of Union Home Minister Amit Shah, whose rise through Indian cricket administration made him the most convenient symbol of the debate over political influence in the BCCI. He was hardly the first political heir to discover the attractions of cricket administration, but he became its most recognisable face.

Rajasthan's latest RCA contest suggests that the cricket pitch is becoming increasingly crowded with political heirs.

The unemployed youth who put up that hoarding at the SMS Stadium may have intended it as satire. But they accidentally produced the perfect slogan for this new Indian career path.

Why queue for a government job when your father can get you a cricket association? And perhaps that is the real joke. In a country where millions of young people spend years preparing for competitive examinations, waiting for vacancies and fighting over a handful of government jobs, political families appear to have discovered a rather more efficient recruitment system.

The only qualification required may be that your father already has a job in politics. And if that job happens to come with enough power, the child's career prospects can stretch well beyond politics - all the way to the cricket stadium.

'DUPAHIYA' SEASON 2

'Everybody's embodiment is in Bhugol'

Sparsh Shrivastava has channelled Govinda, Salman Khan & Madhuri Dixit in the second season

OUR CORRESPONDENT

There is a certain Bollywood nostalgia tucked into Bhugol, the small-town dreamer at the heart of Prime Video's 'Dupahiya'. As the second season takes the much-loved world of Dhadakpur into another round of chaos, Bhugol finds himself navigating newfound fame and dreaming of becoming a star.

For Sparsh Shrivastava, bringing that energy to the character meant drawing from some of the biggest personalities he grew up watching on screen. From Govinda's comic charm to Madhuri Dixit's unmistakable dance legacy, the actor revealed how some of the most iconic Bollywood references became part of Bhugol's personality, even finding their way into some of the season's memorable sequences.

Sharing the inspiration behind the much-talked-about mandir scene from Season 2's trailer, Sparsh said, "The inspiration for that was Govinda sir. There's this moment in 'Raja Babu', I think, where he goes to his mother and says, 'Itna pyaar diya tune mujhe, maa', so I was just trying to channel that feeling. There's a little bit of Govinda in Bhugol; there's a lot of 'Deewaar' and he's also wearing Salman Khan's jacket from 'Maine Pyaar Kiya'. So, in a way, everybody's embodiment is in Bhugol. He's everything. Then there's Madhuri ma'am as well, of course, especially when it comes to the 'launda naach' in his character. I loved bringing all these little references together because that's how I see Bhugol. He's this small-town guy who has absorbed so much from the films and stars he loves."



That Bollywood influence also connects with something much more personal for Sparsh. While shooting the 'launda naach' sequence, an unexpected gesture from the choreographer took him straight back to his early days as a dancer and to one particularly memorable experience from a dance reality show. He recalled, "The choreographer was Kruti and I remember this one specific moment from that 'launda naach'. When I did a dance reality show back in 2010, Saroj Khan ma'am was the judge and after every good dance, she'd give you a Rs 100 note. This time, when I did that shoot, Kruti came to me and gave me a Rs 500 note and I was so emotional."

Picking up from where season one left off, Dupahiya's new season brings back Gajraj Rao, Renuka Shahane, Sparsh Shrivastava, Bhuvan Arora, Shivani Raghuvanshi and Yashpal Sharma, with Dinesh Lal Yadav (Nirahua) joining the ensemble.